Sófocles · *Edipo rey*

Texto en griego y traducción inglesa alineados por pasaje; cada sección de la traducción figura una sola vez, junto al primer pasaje que abarca.

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Locus	Griego	Traducción inglesa
1.1	1 ὦ τέκνα, Κάδμου τοῦ πάλαι νέα τροφή, 2 τίνας ποθ’ ἕδρας τάσδε μοι θοάζετε 3 ἱκτηρίοις κλάδοισιν ἐξεστεμμένοι; 4 πόλις δ’ ὁμοῦ μὲν θυμιαμάτων γέμει, 5 ὁμοῦ δὲ παιάνων τε καὶ στεναγμάτων· 6 ἀγὼ δικαιῶν μὴ παρ’ ἀγγέλων, τέκνα, 7 ἄλλων ἀκούειν αὐτὸς ὧδ’ ἐλήλυθα, 8 ὁ πᾶσι κλεινὸς Οἰδίπους καλούμενος. 9 ἀλλ’ ὦ γεραιέ, φράζ’, ἐπεὶ πρέπων ἔφυς 10 πρὸ τῶνδε φωνεῖν, τίνι τρόπῳ καθέστατε, 11 δείσαντες ἢ στέρξαντες; ὡς θέλοντος ἂν 12 ἐμοῦ προσαρκεῖν πᾶν· δυσάλγητος γὰρ ἂν 13 εἴην τοιάνδε μὴ οὐ κατοικτίρων ἕδραν. 14 ἀλλ’ ὦ κρατύνων Οἰδίπους χώρας ἐμῆς, 15 ὁρᾷς μὲν ἡμᾶς ἡλίκοι προσήμεθα 16 βωμοῖσι τοῖς σοῖς· οἱ μὲν οὐδέπω μακρὰν 17 πτέσθαι σθένοντες, οἱ δὲ σὺν γήρᾳ βαρεῖς, 18 ἱερῆς, ἐγὼ μὲν Ζηνός, οἵδε τ’ ἠθέων 19 λεκτοί· τὸ δ’ ἄλλο φῦλον ἐξεστεμμένον 20 ἀγοραῖσι θακεῖ πρός τε Παλλάδος διπλοῖς 21 ναοῖς, ἐπ’ Ἰσμηνοῦ τε μαντείᾳ σποδῷ. 22 πόλις γάρ, ὥσπερ καὶτὸς εἰσορᾷς, ἄγαν 23 ἤδη σαλεύει κἀνακουφίσαι κάρα 24 βυθῶν ἔτ’ οὐχ οἵα τε φοινίου σάλου, 25 φθίνουσα μὲν κάλυξιν ἐγκάρποις χθονός, 26 φθίνουσα δ’ ἀγέλαις βουνόμοις τόκοισί τε 27 ἀγόνοις γυναικῶν· ἐν δ’ ὁ πυρφόρος θεὸς	1 My children, latest-born wards of old Cadmus, why do you sit before me like this with wreathed branches of suppliants, while the city reeks with incense, 5 rings with prayers for health and cries of woe? I thought it unbefitting, my children, to hear these things from the mouths of others, and have come here myself, I, Oedipus renowned by all. Tell me, then, venerable old man—since it is proper that you 10 speak for these—in what mood you sit here, one of fear or of desire? Be sure that I will gladly give you all my help. I would be hard-hearted indeed if I did not pity such suppliants as these. 14 Oedipus, ruler of my land, you see the age of those who sit 15 on your altars—some, nestlings still too tender for flight, others, bowed with age, priests, like me of Zeus, and some, these here, the chosen youth. The rest of the folk sit 20 with wreathed branches in the market-place, and before the shrines of Pallas, and where Ismenus gives answer by fire. For the city, as you yourself see, is now sorely vexed, and can no longer lift her head from beneath the angry waves of death. 25 A blight has fallen on the fruitful blossoms of the land, the herds among the pastures, the barren pangs of women. And the flaming god, the malign plague, has swooped upon us, and ravages the town: he lays waste to the house of Cadmus, but enriches Hades with 30 groans and tears. It is not because we rank you with the gods that I and these children are suppliants at your hearth, but because we deem you the first among men in life’s common fortunes and in dealings with the divinities: 35 when you came to the city of the Cadmeans, you freed us from the tax that we rendered to the

	28 σκήψας ἐλαύνει, λοιμὸς ἔχθιστος, πόλιν, 29 ὑφ’ οὗ κενοῦται δῶμα Καδμεῖον, μέλας δ’ 30 Ἅιδης στεναγμοῖς καὶ γόοις πλουτίζεται.	hard songstress, and that when you knew no more than anyone else, nor had you been taught, but rather by the assistance of a god, as the story goes, you uplifted our life. 40 Now, Oedipus, king glorious in our eyes, we, your suppliants, beseech you to find some defence for us, whether you hear it from some divine omen, or learn of it from some mortal. For I see that the outcome of the councils of experienced men 45 most often have effect. On, best of mortals, uplift our state! On, guard your fame, since now this land calls you savior on account of your former zeal. Let us not remember of your reign that 50 we were first restored and then cast down: lift this state so that it falls no more! With good omen you provided us that past happiness: show yourself the same now too, since if you are to rule this land just as you do now, it is better to be lord of men than of a wasteland. 55 Neither walled town nor ship is anything, if it is empty and no men dwell within. 58 My piteous children, I know quite well the desires with which you have come: I know well that 60 you all are sick, and though you are sick I know well that there is not one of you who is as sick as I. Your pain comes on each of you for himself alone, and for no other, but my soul is in pain at once for the city, for myself, and for you. 65 Thus you are not awakening me from sleep: no, be sure that I have wept many tears, wandered far and wide in my thought. I have made use of the only remedy which I could find after close consideration: I sent my relative 70 Creon, Menoeceus’ son, to Apollo’s Pythian residence to learn what we might do or say to protect this city. And now, when the lapse of days is reckoned, I am troubled about what he is doing, for he has been away an unreasonably long time 75 beyond what is fitting. But when he arrives, I would be no true man if did not perform all that the god reveals. 78 You have spoken opportunely, since at this time these people here indicate that Creon is drawing near. 80 Lord Apollo, may he come to us in the brightness of saving fortune, even as his face is bright! 82 He seems to bring comfort, since otherwise he would not be coming crowned so thickly with berry-

		laden bay. 84 We will soon know: he is within hearing-range. 85 Prince, my kinsman, child of Menoeceus, what news have you brought us from the god? 87 Good news. I tell you that even troubles hard to bear will end in perfect peace if they find the right issue. 89 But what is the oracle ? So far, your words 90 neither encourage nor frighten me. 91 If you want to hear in the presence of these people, I am ready to speak: otherwise we can go inside. 93 Speak to all. The sorrow that I bear for these is more than for my own life. 95 I will tell you what I heard from the god. Phoebus our lord clearly commands us to drive out the defilement which he said was harbored in this land, and not to nourish it so that it cannot be healed. 99 With what sort of purification? What is the manner of the misfortune?
1.31	31 θεοῖσι μέν νυν οὐκ ἰσούμενόν σ’ ἐγὼ 32 οὐδ’ οἵδε παῖδες ἐζόμεσθ’ ἐφέστιοι, 33 ἀνδρῶν δὲ πρῶτον ἔν τε συμφοραῖς βίου 34 κρίνοντες ἔν τε δαιμόνων συναλλαγαῖς· 35 ὅς γ’ ἐξέλυσας ἄστυ Καδμεῖον μολὼν 36 σκληρᾶς ἀοιδοῦ δασμὸν ὃν παρείχομεν, 37 καὶ ταῦθ’ ὑφ’ ἡμῶν οὐδὲν ἐξειδὼς πλέον 38 οὐδ’ ἐκδιδαχθείς, ἀλλὰ προσθήκῃ θεοῦ 39 λέγει νομίζει θ’ ἡμὶν ὀρθῶσαι βίον· 40 νῦν τ’, ὦ κράτιστον πᾶσιν Οἰδίπου κάρα, 41 ἱκετεύομέν σε πάντες οἵδε πρόστροποι 42 ἀλκήν τιν’ εὑρεῖν ἡμίν, εἴτε του θεῶν 43 φήμην ἀκούσας εἴτ’ ἀπ’ ἀνδρὸς οἶσθά του· 44 ὡς τοῖσιν ἐμπείροισι καὶ τὰς ξυμφορὰς 45 ζώσας ὁρῶ μάλιστα τῶν βουλευμάτων. 46 ἴθ’, ὦ βροτῶν ἄριστ’, ἀνόρθωσον πόλιν, 47 ἴθ’, εὐλαβήθηθ’· ὡς σὲ νῦν μὲν ἥδε γῆ 48 σωτῆρα κλῄζει τῆς πάρος προθυμίας· 49 ἀρχῆς δὲ τῆς σῆς μηδαμῶς μεμνώμεθα	

	50 στάντες τ’ ἐς ὀρθὸν καὶ πεσόντες ὕστερον. 51 ἀλλ’ ἀσφαλείᾳ τήνδ’ ἀνόρθωσον πόλιν· 52 ὄρνιθι γὰρ καὶ τὴν τότ’ αἰσίῳ τύχην 53 παρέσχες ἡμῖν, καὶ τανῦν ἴσος γενοῦ. 54 ὡς εἴπερ ἄρξεις τῆσδε γῆς, ὥσπερ κρατεῖς, 55 ξὺν ἀνδράσιν κάλλιον ἢ κενῆς κρατεῖν· 56 ὡς οὐδέν ἐστιν οὔτε πύργος οὔτε ναῦς 57 ἔρημος ἀνδρῶν μὴ ξυνοικούντων ἔσω. 58 ὦ παῖδες οἰκτροί, γνωτὰ κοὐκ ἄγνωτά μοι 59 προσήλθεθ’ ἱμείροντες· εὖ γὰρ οἶδ’ ὅτι 60 νοσεῖτε πάντες, καὶ νοσοῦντες, ὡς ἐγὼ	
1.61	61 οὐκ ἔστιν ὑμῶν ὅστις ἐξ ἴσου νοσεῖ. 62 τὸ μὲν γὰρ ὑμῶν ἄλγος εἰς ἕν’ ἔρχεται 63 μόνον καθ’ αὑτὸν κοὐδέν’ ἄλλον, ἡ δ’ ἐμὴ 64 ψυχὴ πόλιν τε κἀμὲ καὶ σ’ ὁμοῦ στένει. 65 ὥστ’ οὐχ ὕπνῳ γ’ εὕδοντά μ’ ἐξεγείρετε, 66 ἀλλ’ ἴστε πολλὰ μέν με δακρύσαντα δή, 67 πολλὰς δ’ ὁδοὺς ἐλθόντα φροντίδος πλάνοις· 68 ἣν δ’ εὖ σκοπῶν ηὕρισκον ἴασιν μόνην, 69 ταύτην ἔπραξα· παῖδα γὰρ Μενοικέως 70 Κρέοντ’, ἐμαυτοῦ γαμβρόν, ἐς τὰ Πυθικὰ 71 ἔπεμψα Φοίβου δώμαθ’, ὡς πύθοιθ’ ὅ τι 72 δρῶν ἢ τί φωνῶν τήνδε ῥυσαίμην πόλιν. 73 καί μ’ ἦμαρ ἤδη ξυμμετρούμενον χρόνῳ 74 λυπεῖ τί πράσσει· τοῦ γὰρ εἰκότος πέρα 75 ἄπεστι πλείω τοῦ καθήκοντος χρόνου. 76 ὅταν δ’ ἵκηται, τηνικαῦτ’ ἐγὼ κακὸς 77 μὴ δρῶν ἂν εἴην πάνθ’ ὅσ’ ἂν δηλοῖ θεός. 78 ἀλλ’ εἰς καλὸν σύ τ’ εἶπας οἵδε τ’ ἀρτίως 79 Κρέοντα προσστείχοντα σημαίνουσί μοι. 80 ὦναξ Ἄπολλον, εἰ γὰρ ἐν τύχῃ γέ τῳ	

	81 σωτῆρι βαίη λαμπρὸς ὥσπερ ὄμματι 82 ἀλλ’ εἰκάσαι μέν, ἡδύς· οὐ γὰρ ἂν κάρα 83 πολυστεφὴς ὧδ’ εἶρπε παγκάρπου δάφνης. 84 τάχ’ εἰσόμεσθα· ξύμμετρος γὰρ ὡς κλύειν. 85 ἄναξ, ἐμὸν κήδευμα, παῖ Μενοικέως, 86 τίν’ ἡμὶν ἥκεις τοῦ θεοῦ φήμην φέρων; 87 ἐσθλήν· λέγω γὰρ καὶ τὰ δύσφορ’, εἰ τύχοι 88 κατ’ ὀρθὸν ἐξελθόντα, πάντ’ ἂν εὐτυχεῖν. 89 ἔστιν δὲ ποῖον τοὔπος; οὔτε γὰρ θρασὺς 90 οὔτ’ οὖν προδείσας εἰμὶ τῷ γε νῦν λόγῳ.	
1.91	91 εἰ τῶνδε χρῄζεις πλησιαζόντων κλύειν, 92 ἕτοιμος εἰπεῖν, εἴτε καὶ στείχειν ἔσω. 93 ἐς πάντας αὔδα· τῶνδε γὰρ πλέον φέρω 94 τὸ πένθος ἢ καὶ τῆς ἐμῆς ψυχῆς πέρι. 95 λέγοιμ’ ἂν οἶ’ ἤκουσα τοῦ θεοῦ πάρα. 96 ἄνωγεν ἡμᾶς Φοῖβος ἐμφανῶς ἄναξ 97 μίασμα χώρας, ὡς τεθραμμένον χθονὶ 98 ἐν τῇδ’, ἐλαύνειν μηδ’ ἀνήκεστον τρέφειν. 99 ποίῳ καθαρμῷ; τίς ὁ τρόπος τῆς ξυμφορᾶς; 100 ἀνδρηλατοῦντας ἢ φόνῳ φόνον πάλιν 101 λύοντας, ὡς τόδ’ αἷμα χειμάζον πόλιν. 102 ποίου γὰρ ἀνδρὸς τήνδε μηνύει τύχην; 103 ἦν ἡμίν, ὦναξ, Λάϊός ποθ’ ἡγεμὼν 104 γῆς τῆσδε, πρὶν σὲ τήνδ’ ἀπευθύνειν πόλιν. 105 ἔξοιδ’ ἀκούων· οὐ γὰρ εἰσεῖδόν γέ πω. 106 τούτου θανόντος νῦν ἐπιστέλλει σαφῶς 107 τοὺς αὐτοέντας χειρὶ τιμωρεῖν τινας. 108 οἳ δ’ εἰσὶ ποῦ γῆς; ποῦ τόδ’ εὑρεθήσεται 109 ἴχνος παλαιᾶς δυστέκμαρτον αἰτίας; 110 ἐν τῇδ’ ἔφασκε γῇ· τὸ δὲ ζητούμενον 111 ἁλωτόν, ἐκφεύγειν δὲ	100 By banishing the man, or by paying back bloodshed with bloodshed, since it is this blood which brings the tempest on our city. 102 And who is the man whose fate he thus reveals? 103 Laius, my lord, was the leader of our land before you assumed control of this state. 105 I know it well—by hearsay, for I never saw him. 106 He was slain, and the god now bids us to take vengeance on his murderers, whoever they are. 108 Where on earth are they? Where shall the dim track of this old crime be found? 110 In this land, the god said. What is sought for can be caught; only that which is not watched escapes. 112 Was it in the house, or in the field, or on foreign soil that Laius met his bloody end? 114 He left our land, as he said, on a mission to Delphi. 115 And once he had set forth, he never again returned. 116 And was there none to tell? Was there no travelling companion who saw the deed, from whom tidings might have been gained, and used? 118 All perished, save one who fled in fear, and he could tell with assurance only one thing of all that he saw. 120 And what was that? One thing might hold the clue to many, if we could only get a small beginning for hope. 122 He said that robbers fell upon them, not one man alone, but with a great force. 124 How then, unless some intrigue had been worked with bribes 125 from here in Thebes, would the robbers have been so bold? 126 Such things were surmised. But once Laius was slain no

	τἀμελούμενον. 112 πότερα δ’ ἐν οἴκοις ἢ ’ν ἀγροῖς ὁ Λάϊος 113 ἢ γῆς ἐπ’ ἄλλης τῷδε συμπίπτει φόνῳ; 114 θεωρός, ὡς ἔφασκεν, ἐκδημῶν, πάλιν 115 πρὸς οἶκον οὐκέθ’ ἵκεθ’, ὡς ἀπεστάλη. 116 οὐδ’ ἄγγελός τις οὐδὲ συμπράκτωρ ὁδοῦ 117 κατεῖδ’, ὅτου τις ἐκμαθὼν ἐχρήσατ’ ἄν; 118 θνῄσκουσι γάρ, πλὴν εἷς τις, ὃς φόβῳ, φυγὼν 119 ὧν εἶδε πλὴν ἓν οὐδὲν εἶχ’ εἰδὼς φράσαι. 120 τὸ ποῖον; ἓν γὰρ πόλλ’ ἂν ἐξεύροι μαθεῖν,	avenger arose in the midst of our troubles. 128 But when royalty had fallen in this way, what trouble prevented a full search? 130 The riddling Sphinx had forced us to let things that were obscure go, and to investigate the pressing trouble. 132 I will start afresh, and once more make dark things plain. Worthily has Phoebus Apollo—and worthily have you —bestowed this care on behalf of the dead. And so, as is fitting, you will find me allied with you 135 in seeking vengeance for this land, and for the god as well. I will dispel this taint not on behalf of far-off friends, but for my own benefit. For whoever killed Laius 140 might wish to take vengeance on me also with a hand as fierce. Avenging Laius, therefore, I serve myself. Come, my children, as quickly as possible rise from the altar-steps, and lift these suppliant boughs. Let someone summon here Cadmus’ people, warning them that I will leave nothing untried. 145 For with the god’s help our good fortune—or our ruin—will be made certain. 147 My children, let us rise. What we came to seek, this man promises of his own accord. And may Phoebus, who sent these oracles, 150 come to us as savior and deliverer from the pestilence.
1.121	121 ἀρχὴν βραχεῖαν εἰ λάβοιμεν ἐλπίδος. 122 λῃστὰς ἔφασκε συντυχόντας οὐ μιᾷ 123 ῥώμῃ κτανεῖν νιν, ἀλλὰ σὺν πλήθει χερῶν. 124 πῶς οὖν ὁ λῃστής, εἴ τι μὴ ξὺν ἀργύρῳ 125 ἐπράσσετ’ ἐνθένδ’, ἐς τόδ’ ἂν τόλμης ἔβη; 126 δοκοῦντα ταῦτ’ ἦν· Λαΐου δ’ ὀλωλότος 127 οὐδεὶς ἀρωγὸς ἐν κακοῖς ἐγίγνετο. 128 κακὸν δὲ ποῖον ἐμποδών, τυραννίδος 129 οὕτω πεσούσης, εἶργε τοῦτ’ ἐξειδέναι; 130 ἡ ποικιλῳδὸς Σφὶγξ τὸ πρὸς ποσὶν σκοπεῖν 131 μεθέντας ἡμᾶς τἀφανῆ προσήγετο. 132 ἀλλ’ ἐξ ὑπαρχῆς αὖθις αὖτ’ ἐγὼ φανῶ· 133 ἐπαξίως γὰρ Φοῖβος, ἀξίως δὲ σὺ 134 πρὸ τοῦ θανόντος τήνδ’ ἔθεσθ’ ἐπιστροφήν·	

	135 ὥστ’ ἐνδίκως ὄψεσθε κἀμὲ σύμμαχον 136 γῇ τῇδε τιμωροῦντα τῷ θεῷ θ’ ἅμα. 137 ὑπὲρ γὰρ οὐχὶ τῶν ἀπωτέρω φίλων, 138 ἀλλ’ αὐτὸς αὑτοῦ τοῦτ’ ἀποσκεδῶ μύσος. 139 ὅστις γὰρ ἦν ἐκεῖνον ὁ κτανών, τάχ’ ἂν 140 κἄμ’ ἂν τοιαύτῃ χειρὶ τιμωροῦνθ’ ἕλοι. 141 κείνῳ προσαρκῶν οὖν ἐμαυτὸν ὠφελῶ. 142 ἀλλ’ ὡς τάχιστα, παῖδες, ὑμεῖς μὲν βάθρων 143 ἵστασθε, τούσδ’ ἄραντες ἱκτῆρας κλάδους, 144 ἄλλος δὲ Κάδμου λαὸν ὧδ’ ἀθροιζέτω, 145 ὡς πᾶν ἐμοῦ δράσοντος· ἢ γὰρ εὐτυχεῖς 146 σὺν τῷ θεῷ φανούμεθ’ ἢ πεπτωκότες. 147 ὦ παῖδες, ἱστώμεσθα· τῶνδε γὰρ χάριν 148 καὶ δεῦρ’ ἔβημεν ὧν ὅδ’ ἐξαγγέλλεται. 149 Φοῖβος δ’ ὁ πέμψας τάσδε μαντείας ἅμα 150 σωτήρ δ’ ἵκοιτο καὶ νόσου παυστήριος.	
1.1	151 ὦ Διὸς ἀδυεπὲς φάτι, τίς ποτε τᾶς πολυχρύσου 152 Πυθῶνος ἀγλαὰς ἔβας 153 Θήβας; ἐκτέταμαι φοβερὰν φρένα, δείματι πάλλων, 154 ἰήιε Δάλιε Παιάν, 155 ἀμφὶ σοὶ ἀζόμενος τί μοι ἢ νέον 156 ἢ περιτελλομέναις ὥραις πάλιν ἐξανύσεις χρέος. 157 εἰπέ μοι, ὦ χρυσέας τέκνον Ἐλπίδος, ἄμβροτε Φάμα.	
1.1	160 πρῶτα σὲ κεκλόμενος, θύγατερ Διός, ἄμβροτ’ Ἀθάνα 161 γαιάοχόν τ’ ἀδελφεὰν 162 Ἄρτεμιν, ἃ κυκλόεντ’ ἀγορᾶς θρόνον εὐκλέα θάσσει, 163 καὶ Φοῖβον ἑκαβόλον, ἰὼ 164 τρισσοὶ ἀλεξίμοροι προφάνητέ μοι, 165 εἴ ποτε καὶ προτέρας ἄτας ὕπερ ὀρνυμένας πόλει 166 ἠνύσατ’ ἐκτοπίαν φλόγα πήματος, ἔλθετε καὶ νῦν.	
1.2	169 ὦ πόποι, ἀνάριθμα γὰρ φέρω 170 πήματα· νοσεῖ δέ μοι πρόπας στόλος, οὐδ’ ἔνι φροντίδος ἔγχος 171 ᾧ τις ἀλέξεται. οὔτε γὰρ ἔκγονα	169 Alas, countless are the sorrows I bear. 170 A plague is on all our people, and thought can find no weapon for defense. The fruits of the glorious earth

	172 κλυτᾶς χθονὸς αὔξεται οὔτε τόκοισιν 173 ἰηίων καμάτων ἀνέχουσι γυναῖκες· 175 ἄλλον δ’ ἂν ἄλλῳ προσίδοις ἄπερ εὔπτερον ὄρνιν 176 κρεῖσσον ἀμαιμακέτου πυρὸς ὅρμενον 177 ἀκτὰν πρὸς ἑσπέρου θεοῦ.	do not grow; by no birth of offspring do women surmount the pangs in which they shriek. 175 You can see life after life speed away, like a bird on the wing, swifter than irresistible fire, to the shore of the western god.
1.2	179 ὧν πόλις ἀνάριθμος ὄλλυται· 180 νηλέα δὲ γένεθλα πρὸς πέδῳ θαναταφόρα κεῖται ἀνοίκτως· 181 ἐν δ’ ἄλοχοι πολιαί τ’ ἔπι ματέρες 182 ἀχὰν παραβώμιον ἄλλοθεν ἄλλαν 183 λυγρῶν πόνων ἱκετῆρες ἐπιστενάχουσιν. 185 παιὰν δὲ λάμπει στονόεσσά τε γῆρυς ὅμαυλος 186 ὧν ὕπερ, ὦ χρυσέα θύγατερ Διός, 187 εὐῶπα πέμψον ἀλκάν.	
1.3	190 Ἄρεά τε τὸν μαλερόν, ὃς νῦν ἄχαλκος ἀσπίδων 191 φλέγει με περιβόατον, ἀντιάζω 192 παλίσσυτον δράμημα νωτίσαι πάτρας 193 ἔπουρον, εἴτ’ ἐς μέγαν θάλαμον Ἀμφιτρίτας 195 εἴτ’ ἐς τὸν ἀπόξενον ὅρμων 196 Θρήκιον κλύδωνα· 197 τελεῖν γὰρ εἴ τι νὺξ ἀφῇ, 198 τοῦτ’ ἐπ’ ἦμαρ ἔρχεται· 199 τόν, ὦ τᾶν πυρφόρων 200 ἀστραπᾶν κράτη νέμων, 201 ὦ Ζεῦ πάτερ, ὑπὸ σῷ φθίσον κεραυνῷ,	190 Grant that the fierce god of death, who now without the bronze of shields, though among cries like those of battle, wraps me in the flames of his onset, may turn his back in speedy flight from our land, borne by a favorable wind to the great chamber of Amphitrite, 195 or to the Thracian waves, those waters where none find haven. For if night leaves anything undone in the working of destruction, day follows to accomplish it. You who wield the 200 powers of fiery lightning, Zeus our father, slay him beneath your thunder-bolt.
1.3	203 Λύκει’ ἄναξ, τά τε σὰ χρυσοστρόφων ἀπ’ ἀγκυλᾶν 204 βέλεα θέλοιμ’ ἂν ἀδάματ’ ἐνδατεῖσθαι 205 ἀρωγὰ προσταχθέντα τάς τε πυρφόρους 206 Ἀρτέμιδος αἴγλας, ξὺν αἷς Λύκι’ ὄρεα διᾴσσει· 207 τὸν χρυσομίτραν τε κικλήσκω, 210 τᾶσδ’ ἐπώνυμον γᾶς, 211 οἰνῶπα Βάκχον εὔιον, 212 Μαινάδων ὁμόστολον, 213 πελασθῆναι φλέγοντ’ 214 ἀγλαῶπι ¯ ˘ ¯ 215 πεύκᾳ ’πὶ τὸν ἀπότιμον ἐν θεοῖς θεόν.	
1.216	216 αἰτεῖς· ἃ δ’ αἰτεῖς, τἄμ’ ἐὰν θέλῃς ἔπη 217 κλύων δέχεσθαι τῇ νόσῳ θ’ ὑπηρετεῖν, 218 ἀλκὴν λάβοις ἂν κἀνακούφισιν κακῶν·	216 You pray. And in answer to your prayer, if you will give a loyal reception to my words and minister to your own disease, you may hope to find help and relief from woes. These words I will speak publicly, as one who was a

	219 ἀγὼ ξένος μὲν τοῦ λόγου τοῦδ’ ἐξερῶ, 220 ξένος δὲ τοῦ πραχθέντος· οὐ γὰρ ἂν μακρὰν 221 ἴχνευον αὐτός, μὴ οὐκ ἔχων τι σύμβολον, 222 νῦν δ’ ὕστερος γὰρ ἀστὸς εἰς ἀστοὺς τελῶ, 223 ὑμῖν προφωνῶ πᾶσι Καδμείοις τάδε· 224 ὅστις ποθ’ ὑμῶν Λάϊον τὸν Λαβδάκου 225 κάτοιδεν ἀνδρὸς ἐκ τίνος διώλετο, 226 τοῦτον κελεύω πάντα σημαίνειν ἐμοί· 227 κεἰ μὲν φοβεῖται, τοὐπίκλημ’ ὑπεξελεῖν 228 αὐτὸν καθ’ αὑτοῦ· πείσεται γὰρ ἄλλο μὲν 229 ἀστεργὲς οὐδέν. γῆς δ’ ἄπεισιν ἀσφαλής. 230 εἰ δ’ αὖ τις ἄλλον οἶδεν ἐξ ἄλλης χθονὸς 231 τὸν αὐτόχειρα, μὴ σιωπάτω· τὸ γὰρ 232 κέρδος τελῶ ’γὼ χἡ χάρις προσκείσεται. 233 εἰ δ’ αὖ σιωπήσεσθε, καί τις ἢ φίλου 234 δείσας ἀπώσει τοὔπος ἢ χαὐτοῦ τόδε, 235 ἃκ τῶνδε δράσω, ταῦτα χρὴ κλύειν ἐμοῦ. 236 τὸν ἄνδρ’ ἀπαυδῶ τοῦτον, ὅστις ἐστί, γῆς 237 τῆσδ’, ἧς ἐγὼ κράτη τε καὶ θρόνους νέμω, 238 μήτ’ εἰσδέχεσθαι μήτε προσφωνεῖν τινα, 239 μήτ’ ἐν θεῶν εὐχαῖσι μήτε θύμασιν 240 κοινὸν ποεῖσθαι, μήτε χέρνιβας νέμειν· 241 ὠθεῖν δ’ ἀπ’ οἴκων πάντας, ὡς μιάσματος 242 τοῦδ’ ἡμὶν ὄντος, ὡς τὸ Πυθικὸν θεοῦ 243 μαντεῖον ἐξέφηνεν ἀρτίως ἐμοί. 244 ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν τοιόσδε τῷ τε δαίμονι 245 τῷ τ’ ἀνδρὶ τῷ θανόντι σύμμαχος πέλω·	stranger to the report, 220 a stranger to the deed. I would not go far on the trail if I were tracing it alone, without a clue. But as it is—since it was only after the event that I was counted a Theban among Thebans—to you, Cadmeans all, I do thus proclaim: Whoever knows 225 by whom Laius son of Labdacus was slain, I order him to declare all to me. And if he is afraid, I order him to remove the danger of indictment from his path by denouncing himself: he will suffer no other punishment, but will only leave this land, unhurt. 230 If anyone knows the assassin to be an alien, from another land, let him not keep silent. I will reward him, and my thanks shall rest with him besides. But if he keeps silent, if anyone, through fear, seeks to screen himself or a friend from my orders, 235 then hear what I shall do: I charge you that no resident of this land, which I rule, give shelter to or address that murderer, whoever he is, or make him a partner in prayer or sacrifice, 240 or give him a share of the lustral rite. Ban him from your houses, all of you, knowing that this is the defilement, as the oracle of the Pythian god has recently shown to me. In this way 245 I am an ally both to the god and to the dead man. And I pray solemnly that the slayer, whoever he is, whether he alone is guilty or he has partners, may, in the horrible way he deserves, wear out his unblest life. And for myself I pray that if he should, 250 with my knowledge, become a resident of my house, I may suffer the same things which I have just called down on others. And I order you to make all these words good, for my sake, for the sake of the god, and for the sake of our land, thus rendered unfruitful and ungodly. 255 For even if the matter had not been urged upon us by a god, it still would not have been fit that you should leave the guilt unpunished as it is, when one so noble—and he your king—had perished. You should have searched it out. But now, since I hold the powers which he once held, 260 possessing his bed and the wife who bore his children, and since, had his hope of offspring not been unsuccessful, children born of one mother would have tied us with a

		common bond—as it was, fate swooped upon his head—I will uphold this cause, as though it were that of my own father, 265 and will leave no stone unturned in my search for the one who shed the blood, for the honor of the son of Labdacus and of Polydorus and the elder Cadmus and Agenor of old. And for those who do not obey me, I pray that the gods 270 send them neither harvest of the earth nor fruit of the womb, but that they perish with the present fate, or one still worse. But to all you, the loyal Cadmeans who are satisfied by these things, may justice, our ally, 275 and all the gods be gracious always. 276 As you have put me under oath, on my oath, my king, I will speak. I am not the slayer, nor can I reveal him. As for the investigation, it was for Phoebus, who enjoined it, to tell us who did the deed. 280 Justly said. But no man on earth can force the gods to do what they do not want. 282 I would like to say what seems to me the next best course. 283 And if there is a third course, do not hesitate to reveal it too. 284 I know that our lord Teiresias is the seer most like our 285 lord Apollo: from him, my king, an investigator might learn most clearly about these affairs. 287 Not even this have I neglected. On Creon’s suggestion, I sent a man twice to bring him. And I have been wondering for some time why he is not here. 290 Indeed—his skill apart—the rumors are but faint and old. 291 What are the rumors? I am investigating every tale. 292 He was said to have been killed by some wayfarers. 293 I too have heard that. But no one sees the one who saw it. 294 If he knows what fear is, he will not hesitate to come forward when he 295 hears your curses, so dire are they. 296 When a man does not shrink from a deed, he is not scared by a word. 297 But there is one to convict him. But here they bring at last the godlike prophet, the only man in whom truth lives. 300 Teiresias, whose soul grasps all things, both that which may be told and that which is unspeakable, the Olympian secrets and the affairs of the earth, you feel, though you cannot see, what a huge plague haunts our state. From which, great prophet, we find you to be our protector and only savior. 305

		Now, Phoebus—if indeed you have not already heard the news—sent answer to our question that the only way to rid ourselves of this pest that afflicts us is to discover the slayers of Laius, and then to slay them or banish them from our land.
1.246	246 κατεύχομαι δὲ τὸν δεδρακότ’, εἴτε τις 247 εἷς ὢν λέληθεν εἴτε πλειόνων μέτα, 248 κακὸν κακῶς νιν ἄμορον ἐκτρῖψαι βίου· 249 ἐπεύχομαι δ’, οἴκοισιν εἰ ξυνέστιος 250 ἐν τοῖς ἐμοῖς γένοιτ’ ἐμοῦ συνειδότος, 251 παθεῖν ἅπερ τοῖσδ’ ἀρτίως ἠρασάμην. 252 ὑμῖν δὲ ταῦτα πάντ’ ἐπισκήπτω τελεῖν, 253 ὑπέρ τ’ ἐμαυτοῦ τοῦ θεοῦ τε τῆσδέ τε 254 γῆς ὦδ’ ἀκάρπως κἀθέως ἐφθαρμένης. 255 οὐδ’ εἰ γὰρ ἦν τὸ πρᾶγμα μὴ θεήλατον, 256 ἀκάθαρτον ὑμᾶς εἰκὸς ἦν οὕτως ἐᾶν, 257 ἀνδρός γ’ ἀρίστου βασιλέως τ’ ὀλωλότος, 258 ἀλλ’ ἐξερευνᾶν· νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ κυρῶ γ’ ἐγὼ 259 ἔχων μὲν ἀρχὰς ἃς ἐκεῖνος εἶχε πρίν, 260 ἔχων δὲ λέκτρα καὶ γυναῖχ’ ὁμόσπορον, 261 κοινῶν τε παίδων κοίν’ ἄν, εἰ κείνῳ γένος 262 μὴ ’δυστύχησεν, ἦν ἂν ἐκπεφυκότα· 263 νῦν δ’ ἐς τὸ κείνου κρᾶτ’ ἐνήλαθ’ ἡ τύχη· 264 ἀνθ’ ὧν ἐγὼ τάδ’, ὡσπερεὶ τοὐμοῦ πατρός, 265 ὑπερμαχοῦμαι κἀπὶ πᾶν ἀφίξομαι, 266 ζητῶν τὸν αὐτόχειρα τοῦ φόνου λαβεῖν, 267 τῷ Λαβδακείῳ παιδὶ Πολυδώρου τε καὶ 268 τοῦ πρόσθε Κάδμου τοῦ πάλαι τ’ Ἀγήνορος. 269 καὶ ταῦτα τοῖς μὴ δρῶσιν εὔχομαι θεοὺς 270 μήτ’ ἄροτον αὐτοῖς γῆς ἀνιέναι τινὰ 271 μήτ’ οὖν γυναικῶν παῖδας, ἀλλὰ τῷ πότμῳ	

	272 τῷ νῦν φθερεῖσθαι κἄτι τοῦδ’ ἐχθίονι· 273 ὑμῖν δὲ τοῖς ἄλλοισι Καδμείοις, ὅσοις 274 τάδ’ ἔστ’ ἀρέσκονθ’, ἥ τε σύμμαχος Δίκη 275 χοἱ πάντες εὖ ξυνεῖεν εἰσαεὶ θεοί.	
1.276	276 ὥσπερ μ’ ἀραῖον ἔλαβες, ὦδ’, ἄναξ, ἐρῶ. 277 οὔτ’ ἔκτανον γὰρ οὔτε τὸν κτανόντ’ ἔχω 278 δεῖξαι. τὸ δὲ ζήτημα τοῦ πέμψαντος ἦν 279 Φοίβου τόδ’ εἰπεῖν, ὅστις εἴργασταί ποτε. 280 δίκαι’ ἔλεξας· ἀλλ’ ἀναγκάσαι θεοὺς 281 ἂν μὴ θέλωσιν οὐδ’ ἂν εἷς δύναιτ’ ἀνήρ. 282 τὰ δεύτερ’ ἐκ τῶνδ’ ἂν λέγοιμ’ ἀμοὶ δοκεῖ. 283 εἰ καὶ τρίτ’ ἐστί, μὴ παρῇς τὸ μὴ οὐ φράσαι. 284 ἄνακτ’ ἄνακτι ταὔθ’ ὁρῶντ’ ἐπίσταμαι 285 μάλιστα Φοίβῳ Τειρεσίαν, παρ’ οὗ τις ἂν 286 σκοπῶν τάδ’, ὦναξ, ἐκμάθοι σαφέστατα. 287 ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἐν ἀργοῖς οὐδὲ τοῦτ’ ἐπραξάμην. 288 ἔπεμψα γὰρ Κρέοντος εἰπόντος διπλοῦς 289 πομπούς· πάλαι δὲ μὴ παρῶν θαυμάζεται. 290 καὶ μὴν τά γ’ ἄλλα κωφὰ καὶ παλαί’ ἔπη. 291 τὰ ποῖα ταῦτα; πάντα γὰρ σκοπῶ λόγον. 292 θανεῖν ἐλέχθη πρός τινων ὁδοιπόρων. 293 ἤκουσα κἀγώ. τὸν δ’ ἰδόντ’ οὐδεὶς ὁρᾷ. 294 ἀλλ’ εἴ τι μὲν δὴ δείματός γ’ ἔχει μέρος, 295 τὰς σὰς ἀκούων οὐ μενεῖ τοιάσδ’ ἀράς, 296 ᾧ μή ’στι δρῶντι τάρβος, οὐδ’ ἔπος φοβεῖ. 297 ἀλλ’ οὐξελέγξων αὐτὸν ἔστιν· οἵδε γὰρ 298 τὸν θεῖον ἤδη μάντιν ὧδ’ ἄγουσιν, ᾧ 299 τἀληθὲς ἐμπέφυκεν ἀνθρώπων μόνῳ. 300 ὦ πάντα νωμῶν Τειρεσία, διδακτά τε 301 ἄρρητά τ’, οὐράνιά τε καὶ	

	χθονοστιβῆ, 302 πόλιν μέν, εἰ καὶ μὴ βλέπεις, φρονεῖς δ’ ὅμως 303 οἵᾳ νόσῳ σύνεστιν· ἧς σὲ προστάτην 304 σωτῆρά τ’, ὦναξ, μοῦνον ἐξευρίσκομεν. 305 Φοῖβος γάρ, εἴ τι μὴ κλύεις τῶν ἀγγέλων,	
1.306	306 πέμψασιν ἡμῖν ἀντέπεμψεν, ἔκλυσιν 307 μόνην ἂν ἐλθεῖν τοῦδε τοῦ νοσήματος, 308 εἰ τοὺς κτανόντας Λάϊον μαθόντες εὖ 309 κτείναιμεν ἢ γῆς φυγάδας ἐκπεμψαίμεθα. 310 σύ νυν φθονήσας μήτ’ ἀπ’ οἰωνῶν φάτιν 311 μήτ’ εἴ τιν’ ἄλλην μαντικῆς ἔχεις ὁδόν, 312 ῥῦσαι σεαυτὸν καὶ πόλιν, ῥῦσαι δ’ ἐμέ, 313 ῥῦσαι δὲ πᾶν μίασμα τοῦ τεθνηκότος. 314 ἐν σοὶ γὰρ ἐσμέν· ἄνδρα δ’ ὠφελεῖν ἀφ’ ὧν 315 ἔχοι τε καὶ δύναιτο, κάλλιστος πόνων. 316 φεῦ φεῦ, φρονεῖν ὡς δεινὸν ἔνθα μὴ τέλη 317 λύῃ φρονοῦντι· ταῦτα γὰρ καλῶς ἐγὼ 318 εἰδὼς διώλεσ’· οὐ γὰρ ἂν δεῦρ’ ἱκόμην. 319 τί δ’ ἔστιν; ὡς ἄθυμος εἰσελήλυθας. 320 ἄφες μ’ ἐς οἴκους· ῥᾷστα γὰρ τὸ σόν τε σὺ 321 κἀγὼ διοίσω τοὐμόν, ἢν ἐμοὶ πίθῃ. 322 οὔτ’ ἔννομ’ εἶπας οὔτε προσφιλῆ πόλει 323 τῇδ’, ἥ σ’ ἔθρεψε, τήνδ’ ἀποστερῶν φάτιν. 324 ὁρῶ γὰρ οὐδὲ σοὶ τὸ σὸν φώνημ’ ἰὸν 325 πρὸς καιρόν· ὡς οὖν μηδ’ ἐγὼ ταὐτὸν πάθω— 326 μὴ πρὸς θεῶν φρονῶν γ’ ἀποστραφῇς, ἐπεὶ 327 πάντες σε προσκυνοῦμεν οἵδ’ ἱκτήριοι. 328 πάντες γὰρ οὐ φρονεῖτ’· ἐγὼ δ’ οὐ μή ποτε 329 τἄμ’, ὡς ἂν εἴπω μὴ τὰ σ’, ἐκφήνω κακά. 330 τί φής; ξυνειδὼς οὐ φράσεις, ἀλλ’ ἐννοεῖς	310 So do not begrudge us the voice of the birds or any other path of prophecy, but save yourself and your state, save me, save all that is defiled by the dead. We are in your hands, and man’s noblest task is to help others 315 to the best of his means and powers. 316 Alas, how terrible it is to have wisdom when it does not benefit those who have it. I knew this well, but let it slip from my mind: otherwise I would not have come here. 319 What now? How disheartened you have come! 320 Let me go home. For you will bear your own burden to the end, and I will bear mine, if you consent. 322 Your words are strange and unkind to the state which nurtured you, since you withhold this response. 324 I see that you, for your part, speak inappropriately. 325 Therefore do not speak, so I will not suffer the same. 326 For the love of the gods, do not turn away, if you have knowledge: all we suppliants implore you on our knees. 328 For all of you are without knowledge. But never will I reveal my troubles—not to call them yours. 330 What are you saying? Do you know the secret and refuse to tell it? Will you betray and destroy the state? 332 I will grieve neither myself nor you. Why do you ask these things in vain? You will not learn the answers from me. 334 Will you not, basest of the base— 335 you would anger a stone —speak out? can nothing touch you? Will you never make an end? 337 You blame my anger, but do not perceive your own: no, you blame me. 339 Who would not be angry hearing such words, 340 with which you now are slighting the city? 341 The future will come of itself, though I shroud it in silence. 342 Since it must come anyway, it is right that you tell it to me. 343 I will speak no further: rage, if you wish, with the fiercest wrath your heart knows. 345 In my anger I will not spare to speak all my thoughts. Know that

	331 ἡμᾶς προδοῦναι καὶ καταφθεῖραι πόλιν; 332 ἐγὼ οὔτ’ ἐμαυτὸν οὔτε σ’ ἀλγυνῶ. τί ταῦτ’ 333 ἄλλως ἐλέγχεις; οὐ γὰρ ἂν πύθοιό μου. 334 οὐκ, ὦ κακῶν κάκιστε, καὶ γὰρ ἂν πέτρου 335 φύσιν σύ γ’ ὀργάνειας, ἐξερεῖς ποτε,	you seem to me to have helped in plotting the deed, and to have done it, short of performing the actual murder with your own hands: if you had eyesight, I would have said that you had done even this by yourself. 350 In truth? I order you to abide by you own decree, and from this day forth not to speak to these men or to me: you are the accursed defiler of this land. 354 So brazen with your blustering taunt? 355 Where do you think to escape to? 356 I have escaped. There is strength in my truth. 357 Who taught you this? Not your skill, at any rate. 358 You yourself. For you spurred me on to speak against my will. 359 What did you say? Speak again, so I may learn it better. 360 Did you not understand before, or are you talking to test me? 361 I cannot say I understood fully. Tell me again.
1.336	336 ἀλλ’ ὧδ’ ἄτεγκτος κἀτελεύτητος φανεῖ; 337 ὀργὴν ἐμέμψω τὴν ἐμήν, τὴν σὴν δ’ ὁμοῦ 338 ναίουσαν οὐ κατεῖδες, ἀλλ’ ἐμὲ ψέγεις. 339 τίς γὰρ τοιαῦτ’ ἂν οὐκ ἂν ὀργίζοιτ’ ἔπη 340 κλύων, ἃ νῦν σὺ τήνδ’ ἀτιμάζεις πόλιν; 341 ἥξει γὰρ αὐτά, κἂν ἐγὼ σιγῇ στέγω. 342 οὐκοῦν ἅ γ’ ἥξει καὶ σὲ χρὴ λέγειν ἐμοί. 343 οὐκ ἂν πέρα φράσαιμι. πρὸς τάδ’, εἰ θέλεις, 344 θυμοῦ δι’ ὀργῆς ἥτις ἀγριωτάτη. 345 καὶ μὴν παρήσω γ’ οὐδέν, ὡς ὀργῆς ἔχω, 346 ἅπερ ξυνίημ’· ἴσθι γὰρ δοκῶν ἐμοὶ 347 καὶ ξυμφυτεῦσαι τοὔργον εἰργάσθαι θ’, ὅσον 348 μὴ χερσὶ καίνων· εἰ δ’ ἐτύγχανες βλέπων, 349 καὶ τοὔργον ἂν σοῦ τοῦτ’, ἔφην εἶναι μόνου. 350 ἆληθες; ἐννέπω σὲ τῷ κηρύγματι 351 ᾧπερ προεῖπας ἐμμένειν, κἀφ’ ἡμέρας 352 τῆς νῦν προσαυδᾶν μήτε τούσδε μήτ’ ἐμέ, 353 ὡς ὄντι γῆς τῆσδ’ ἀνοσίῳ μιάστορι. 354 οὕτως ἀναιδῶς ἐξεκίνησας τόδε 355 τὸ ῥῆμα; καὶ ποῦ τοῦτο φεύξεσθαι δοκεῖς;	362 I say that you are the killer of the man whose slayer you seek. 363 Now you will regret that you have said such dire words twice. 364 Should I tell you more, that you might get more angry? 365 Say as much as you want: it will be said in vain. 366 I say that you have been living in unguessed shame with your closest kin, and do not see into what woe you have fallen. 368 Do you think that you will always be able to speak like this without smarting for it? 369 Yes, if indeed there is any strength in truth. 370 But there is, except not for you. You do not have that strength, since you are maimed in your ears, in your wit, and in your eyes. 372 And you are a poor wretch to utter taunts that every man here will soon hurl at you. 374 Night, endless night has you in her keeping, so that you can never hurt me, 375 or any man that sees the light of the sun. 376 No, it is not your fate to fall at my hands, since Apollo, to whom this matter is a concern, is sufficient. 378 Are these Creon’s devices, or your own? 379 Creon is no trouble for you: you are your own. 380 O wealth, and empire, and skill surpassing skill in life’s keen rivalries, how great is the envy in your keeping, if for the sake of this office which the city has entrusted to me, a gift unsought, 385 Creon the trustworthy, Creon, my old friend, has crept upon me by stealth, yearning to overthrow me, and has suborned such

	356 πέφευγα· τἀληθὲς γὰρ ἰσχῦον τρέφω. 357 πρὸς τοῦ διδαχθείς; οὐ γὰρ ἔκ γε τῆς τέχνης. 358 πρὸς σοῦ· σὺ γάρ μ’ ἄκοντα προυτρέψω λέγειν. 359 ποῖον λόγον; λέγ’ αὖθις, ὡς μᾶλλον μάθω. 360 οὐχὶ ξυνῆκας πρόσθεν; ἢ ’κπειρᾷ λέγων; 361 οὐχ ὥστε γ’ εἰπεῖν γνωστόν· ἀλλ’ αὖθις φράσον. 362 φονέα σε φημὶ τἀνδρὸς οὗ ζητεῖς κυρεῖν. 363 ἀλλ’ οὔ τι χαίρων δίς γε πημονὰς ἐρεῖς. 364 εἴπω τι δῆτα κἄλλ’, ἵν’ ὀργίζῃ πλέον; 365 ὅσον γε χρῄζεις· ὡς μάτην εἰρήσεται.	a scheming juggler as this, a tricky quack, who has eyes only for profit, but is blind in his art! 390 Come, tell me, where have you proved yourself a seer? Why, when the watchful dog who wove dark song was here, did you say nothing to free the people? Yet the riddle, at least, was not for the first comer to read: there was need of a seer’s help, 395 and you were discovered not to have this art, either from birds, or known from some god. But rather I, Oedipus the ignorant, stopped her, having attained the answer through my wit alone, untaught by birds. It is I whom you are trying to oust, assuming that 400 you will have great influence in Creon’s court. But I think that you and the one who plotted these things will rue your zeal to purge the land: if you did not seem to be an old man, you would have learned to your cost how haughty you are. 404 To our way of thinking, these words, both his and yours, Oedipus, 405 have been said in anger. We have no need of this, but rather we must seek how we shall best discharge the mandates of the god. 408 Though you are king, the right of reply must be considered the same for both: over that I have control. 410 For I do not live as your slave, but as Loxias’. I will not stand enrolled as Creon’s client. And I tell you, since you have taunted my blindness, that though you have sight, you do not see what a state of misery you are in, or where you dwell, or with whom. 415 Do you know who your parents are? You have been an unwitting enemy to your own kin, both in the Underworld and on the earth above, and the double lash of your mother’s and your father’s curse will one day drive you from this land in dreadful haste, with darkness upon those eyes of yours which now can see. 420 What place will be harbor to your cries, what part of all Cithaeron will not ring with them soon, when you have learned the meaning of the nuptials in which, within that house, you found a fatal haven, after a voyage so fair? And you have not guessed at a throng of other ills 425 which will bring you level with your true self and with your own children. Therefore heap your scorn upon Creon and upon my message: for no man will ever be

		crushed more miserably than you. 429 Are these taunts to be endured from him? 430 Be gone, to your ruin; be gone this instant! Will you not turn your back and leave this house? 432 I would not have come if you had not called me. 433 I did not know you would speak foolishly, for otherwise it would have been a long time before I summoned you to my home.
1.366	366 λεληθέναι σε φημὶ σὺν τοῖς φιλτάτοις 367 αἴσχισθ’ ὁμιλοῦντ’, οὐδ’ ὁρᾶν ἵν’ εἶ κακοῦ. 368 ἦ καὶ γεγηθὼς ταῦτ’ ἀεὶ λέξειν δοκεῖς; 369 εἴπερ τί γ’ ἐστὶ τῆς ἀληθείας σθένος. 370 ἀλλ’ ἔστι, πλὴν σοί· σοὶ δὲ τοῦτ’ οὐκ ἔστ’ ἐπεὶ 371 τυφλὸς τά τ’ ὦτα τόν τε νοῦν τά τ’ ὄμματ’ εἶ. 372 σὺ δ’ ἄθλιός γε ταῦτ’ ὀνειδίζων, ἃ σοὶ 373 οὐδεὶς ὃς οὐχὶ τῶνδ’ ὀνειδιεῖ τάχα. 374 μιᾶς τρέφει πρὸς νυκτός, ὥστε μήτ’ ἐμὲ 375 μήτ’ ἄλλον, ὅστις φῶς ὁρᾷ, βλάψαι ποτ’ ἄν. 376 οὐ γάρ σε μοῖρα πρός γ’ ἐμοῦ πεσεῖν, ἐπεὶ 377 ἱκανὸς Ἀπόλλων, ᾧ τάδ’ ἐκπρᾶξαι μέλει. 378 Κρέοντος ἢ σοῦ ταῦτα τἀξευρήματα; 379 Κρέων δέ σοι πῆμ’ οὐδέν, ἀλλ’ αὐτὸς σὺ σοί. 380 ὦ πλοῦτε καὶ τυραννὶ καὶ τέχνη τέχνης 381 ὑπερφέρουσα τῷ πολυζήλῳ βίῳ, 382 ὅσος παρ’ ὑμῖν ὁ φθόνος φυλάσσεται, 383 εἰ τῆσδέ γ’ ἀρχῆς οὕνεχ’, ἣν ἐμοὶ πόλις 384 δωρητόν, οὐκ αἰτητόν, εἰσεχείρισεν, 385 ταύτης Κρέων ὁ πιστός, οὐξ ἀρχῆς φίλος, 386 λάθρᾳ μ’ ὑπελθὼν ἐκβαλεῖν ἱμείρεται, 387 ὑφεὶς μάγον τοιόνδε μηχανορράφον, 388 δόλιον ἀγύρτην, ὅστις ἐν τοῖς κέρδεσιν 389 μόνον δέδορκε, τὴν τέχνην δ’ ἔφυ τυφλός. 390 ἐπεί, φέρ’ εἰπέ, ποῦ σὺ μάντις εἶ σαφής;	

	391 πῶς οὐκ, ὅθ’ ἡ ῥαψῳδὸς ἐνθάδ’ ἦν κύων, 392 ηὔδας τι τοῖσδ’ ἀστοῖσιν ἐκλυτήριον; 393 καίτοι τό γ’ αἴνιγμ’ οὐχὶ τοὐπιόντος ἦν 394 ἀνδρὸς διειπεῖν, ἀλλὰ μαντείας ἔδει· 395 ἣν οὔτ’ ἀπ’ οἰωνῶν σὺ προυφάνης ἔχων	
1.396	396 οὔτ’ ἐκ θεῶν του γνωτόν· ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ μολών, 397 ὁ μηδὲν εἰδὼς Οἰδίπους, ἔπαυσά νιν, 398 γνώμῃ κυρήσας οὐδ’ ἀπ’, οἰωνῶν μαθών· 399 ὃν δὴ σὺ πειρᾷς ἐκβαλεῖν, δοκῶν θρόνοις 400 παραστατήσειν τοῖς Κρεοντείοις πέλας. 401 κλαίων δοκεῖς μοι καὶ σὺ χὠ συνθεὶς τάδε 402 ἀγηλατήσειν· εἰ δὲ μὴ ’δόκεις γέρων 403 εἶναι, παθὼν ἔγνως ἂν οἷά περ φρονεῖς. 404 ἡμῖν μὲν εἰκάζουσι καὶ τὰ τοῦδ’ ἔπη 405 ὀργῇ λελέχθαι καὶ τά σ’, Οἰδίπους, δοκεῖ, 406 δεῖ δ’ οὐ τοιούτων, ἀλλ’ ὅπως τὰ τοῦ θεοῦ 407 μαντεῖ’ ἄριστα λύσομεν, τόδε σκοπεῖν. 408 εἰ καὶ τυραννεῖς, ἐξισωτέον τὸ γοῦν 409 ἴσ’ ἀντιλέξαι· τοῦδε γὰρ κἀγὼ κρατῶ. 410 οὐ γάρ τι σοὶ ζῶ δοῦλος, ἀλλὰ Λοξίᾳ· 411 ὥστ’ οὐ Κρέοντος προστάτου γεγράψομαι. 412 λέγω δ’, ἐπειδὴ καὶ τυφλόν μ’ ὠνείδισας· 413 σὺ καὶ δέδορκας κοὐ βλέπεις ἵν’ εἶ κακοῦ, 414 οὐδ’ ἔνθα ναίεις, οὐδ’ ὅτων οἰκεῖς μέτα. 415 ἆρ’ οἶσθ’ ἀφ’ ὧν εἶ; καὶ λέληθας ἐχθρὸς ὢν 416 τοῖς σοῖσιν αὐτοῦ νέρθε κἀπὶ γῆς ἄνω, 417 καί σ’ ἀμφιπλὴξ μητρός τε καὶ τοῦ σοῦ πατρὸς 418 ἐλᾷ ποτ’ ἐκ γῆς τῆσδε δεινόπους ἀρά, 419 βλέποντα νῦν μὲν ὀρθ’, ἔπειτα δὲ σκότον.	

	420 βοῆς δὲ τῆς σῆς ποῖος οὐκ ἔσται λιμήν, 421 ποῖος Κιθαιρὼν οὐχὶ σύμφωνος τάχα, 422 ὅταν καταίσθῃ τὸν ὑμέναιον, ὃν δόμοις 423 ἄνορμον εἰσέπλευσας, εὐπλοίας τυχών; 424 ἄλλων δὲ πλῆθος οὐκ ἐπαισθάνει κακῶν, 425 ἃ σ’ ἐξισώσει σοί τε καὶ τοῖς σοῖς τέκνοις.	
1.426	426 πρὸς ταῦτα καὶ Κρέοντα καὶ τοὐμὸν στόμα 427 προπηλάκιζε· σοῦ γὰρ οὐκ ἔστιν βροτῶν 428 κάκιον ὅστις ἐκτριβήσεταί ποτε. 429 ἦ ταῦτα δῆτ’ ἀνεκτὰ πρὸς τούτου κλύειν; 430 οὐκ εἰς ὄλεθρον; οὐχὶ θᾶσσον; οὐ πάλιν 431 ἄψορρος οἴκων τῶνδ’ ἀποστραφεὶς ἄπει; 432 οὐδ’ ἱκόμην ἔγωγ’ ἄν, εἰ σὺ μὴ ’κάλεις. 433 οὐ γάρ τί σ’ ἤδη μῶρα φωνήσοντ’, ἐπεὶ 434 σχολῇ σ’ ἂν οἴκους τοὺς ἐμοὺς ἐστειλάμην. 435 ἡμεῖς τοιοίδ’ ἔφυμεν, ὡς μὲν σοὶ δοκεῖ, 436 μῶροι, γονεῦσι δ’, οἵ σ’ ἔφυσαν, ἔμφρονες. 437 ποίοισι; μεῖνον, τίς δέ μ’ ἐκφύει βροτῶν; 438 ἥδ’ ἡμέρα φύσει σε καὶ διαφθερεῖ. 439 ὡς πάντ’ ἄγαν αἰνικτὰ κἀσαφῆ λέγεις. 440 οὔκουν σὺ ταῦτ’ ἄριστος εὑρίσκειν ἔφυς; 441 τοιαῦτ’ ὀνείδιζ’, οἷς ἔμ’ εὑρήσεις μέγαν. 442 αὕτη γε μέντοι σ’ ἡ τύχη διώλεσεν. 443 ἀλλ’ εἰ πόλιν τήνδ’ ἐξέσωσ’, οὔ μοι μέλει. 444 ἄπειμι τοίνυν· καὶ σύ, παῖ, κόμιζέ με. 445 κομιζέτω δῆθ’· ὡς παρὼν σύ γ’ ἐμποδὼν 446 ὀχλεῖς, συθείς τ’ ἂν οὐκ ἂν ἀλγύνοις πλέον. 447 εἰπὼν ἄπειμ’ ὧν οὕνεκ’, ἦλθον, οὐ τὸ σὸν 448 δείσας πρόσωπον· οὐ γὰρ ἔσθ’ ὅπου μ’ ὀλεῖς. 449 λέγω δέ σοι· τὸν ἄνδρα τοῦτον, ὃν πάλαι 450 ζητεῖς ἀπειλῶν κἀνακηρύσσων	435 I was born like this—as you think, a fool, but in the opinion of the parents who bore you, quite sane. 437 What parents? Wait. What man is my father? 438 This day will reveal your birth and bring your ruin. 439 What riddles, what dark words you always say. 440 Are you not the best at unravelling mysteries? 441 Reproach me in what you will find me to be great. 442 Yet it was just that fortune that undid you. 443 But if it saved this city I care not. 444 I will take my leave. You, boy, lead me. 445 Yes, let him take you: while here, you are a hindrance, a source of trouble. When you have gone, you will vex me no more. 447 I will go when I have performed the errand for which I came, fearless of your frown: you can never destroy me. I tell you: the man whom you have been seeking this long while, 450 uttering threats and proclaiming a search into the murder of Laius, is here, ostensibly an alien sojourner, but soon to be found a native of Thebes; nor will he enjoy his fortune. A blind man, though now he sees, 455 a beggar, though now rich, he will make his way to a foreign land, feeling the ground before him with his staff. And he will be discovered to be at once brother and father of the children with whom he consorts; son and husband of the woman who bore him; 460 heir to his father’s bed, shedder of his father’s blood. So go in and evaluate this, and if you find that I am wrong, say then that I have no wit in prophecy.

	φόνον 451 τὸν Λαΐειον, οὗτός ἐστιν ἐνθάδε, 452 ξένος λόγῳ μέτοικος, εἶτα δ’ ἐγγενὴς 453 φανήσεται Θηβαῖος, οὐδ’ ἡσθήσεται 454 τῇ ξυμφορᾷ· τυφλὸς γὰρ ἐκ δεδορκότος 455 καὶ πτωχὸς ἀντὶ πλουσίου ξένην ἔπι	
1.456	456 σκήπτρῳ προδεικνὺς γαῖαν ἐμπορεύσεται. 457 φανήσεται δὲ παισὶ τοῖς αὐτοῦ ξυνὼν 458 ἀδελφὸς αὐτὸς καὶ πατήρ, κἀξ ἧς ἔφυ 459 γυναικὸς υἱὸς καὶ πόσις, καὶ τοῦ πατρὸς 460 ὁμόσπορός τε καὶ φονεύς. καὶ ταῦτ’ ἰὼν 461 εἴσω λογίζου· κἂν λάβῃς ἐψευσμένον, 462 φάσκειν ἔμ’ ἤδη μαντικῇ μηδὲν φρονεῖν.	
1.1	463 τίς ὄντιν’ ἀ θεσπιέπεια Δελφὶς εἶπε πέτρα 465 ἄρρητ’ ἀρρήτων τελέσαντα φοινίαισι χερσίν; 466 ὥρα νιν ἀελλάδων 467 ἵππων σθεναρώτερον 468 φυγᾷ πόδα νωμᾶν. 469 ἔνοπλος γὰρ ἐπ’ αὐτὸν ἐπενθρῴσκει 470 πυρὶ καὶ στεροπαῖς ὁ Διὸς γενέτας, 471 δειναὶ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕπονται 472 κῆρες ἀναπλάκητοι	
1.1	473 ἔλαμψε γὰρ τοῦ νιφόεντος ἀρτίως φανεῖσα 474 φάμα Παρνασοῦ τὸν ἄδηλον ἄνδρα πάντ’ ἰχνεύειν. 475 φοιτᾷ γὰρ ὑπ’ ἀγρίαν 476 ὕλαν ἀνά τ’ ἄντρα καὶ 477 πέτρας ἰσόταυρος 478 μέλεος μελέῳ ποδὶ χηρεύων, 480 τὰ μεσόμφαλα γᾶς ἀπονοσφίζων 481 μαντεῖα· τὰ δ’ ἀεὶ 482 ζῶντα περιποτᾶται.	
1.2	483 δεινὰ μὲν οὖν, δεινὰ ταράσσει σοφὸς οἰωνοθέτας 485 οὔτε δοκοῦντ’ οὔτ’ ἀποφάσκονθ’· ὅ τι λέξω δ’ ἀπορῶ. 486 πέτομαι δ’ ἐλπίσιν οὔτ’, ἐνθάδ’ ὀρῶν οὔτ’ ὀπίσω. 487 τί γὰρ ἢ Λαβδακίδαις 490 ἢ τῷ Πολύβου νεῖκος ἔκειτ’, οὔτε πάροιθέν ποτ’ ἔγωγ’	

	491 ἔμαθον, πρὸς ὅτου δὴ βασανίζων βασάνῳ 492 ἐπὶ τὰν ἐπίδαμον φάτιν εἶμ’ Οἰδιπόδα Λαβδακίδαις 495 ἐπίκουρος ἀδήλων θανάτων.	
1.2	496 ἀλλ’ ὁ μὲν οὖν Ζεὺς ὅ τ’ Ἀπόλλων ξυνετοὶ καὶ τὰ βροτῶν 500 εἰδότες· ἀνδρῶν δ’ ὅτι μάντις πλέον ἢ ’γὼ φέρεται, 501 κρίσις οὐκ ἔστιν ἀλαθής· σοφίᾳ δ’ ἂν σοφίαν 502 παραμείψειεν ἀνήρ. 505 ἀλλ’ οὔποτ’ ἔγωγ’ ἄν, πρὶν ἴδοιμ’ ὀρθὸν ἔπος, μεμφομένων ἂν καταφαίην. 506 φανερὰ γὰρ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ, πτερόεσσ’ ἦλθε κόρα 510 ποτέ, καὶ σοφὸς ὤφθη βασάνῳ θ’ ἁδύπολις τῷ ἀπ’ ἐμᾶς 511 φρενὸς οὔποτ’ ὀφλήσει κακίαν.	
1.513	513 ἄνδρες πολῖται, δείν’ ἔπη πεπυσμένος 514 κατηγορεῖν μου τὸν τύραννον Οἰδίπουν, 515 πάρειμ’ ἀτλητῶν. εἰ γὰρ ἐν ταῖς ξυμφοραῖς 516 ταῖς νῦν νομίζει πρός γ’ ἐμοῦ πεπονθέναι 517 λόγοισιν εἴτ’ ἔργοισιν εἰς βλάβην φέρον, 518 οὔτοι βίου μοι τοῦ μακραίωνος πόθος, 519 φέροντι τήνδε βάξιν. οὐ γὰρ εἰς ἁπλοῦν 520 ἡ ζημία μοι τοῦ λόγου τούτου φέρει, 521 ἀλλ’ ἐς μέγιστον, εἰ κακὸς μὲν ἐν πόλει, 522 κακὸς δὲ πρὸς σοῦ καὶ φίλων κεκλήσομαι. 523 ἀλλ’ ἦλθε μὲν δὴ τοῦτο τοὔνειδος τάχ’ ἂν 524 ὀργῇ βιασθὲν μᾶλλον ἢ γνώμῃ φρενῶν. 525 τοὔπος δ’ ἐφάνθη, ταῖς ἐμαῖς γνώμαις ὅτι 526 πεισθεὶς ὁ μάντις τοὺς λόγους ψευδεῖς λέγοι; 527 ηὐδᾶτο μὲν τάδ’, οἶδα δ’ οὐ γνώμῃ τίνι. 528 ἐξ ὀμμάτων δ’ ὀρθῶν τε κἀξ ὀρθῆς φρενὸς 529 κατηγορεῖτο τοὐπίκλημα τοῦτό μου; 530 οὐκ οἶδ’· ἃ γὰρ δρῶσ’, οἱ κρατοῦντες οὐχ ὁρῶ. 531 αὐτὸς δ’ ὅδ’ ἤδη δωμάτων ἔξω	513 Fellow citizens, having learned that Oedipus the king lays dire charges against me, I have come in indignation. 515 If he thinks that in the present troubles he has suffered from me, by word or by deed, anything harmful, truly I do not desire my full term of years, when I must bear such blame as this. The wrong of this rumor 520 touches me not in one point alone, but has the largest scope, if I am to be called a traitor in the city, a traitor by you and by my friends. 523 But perhaps this taunt came under the stress of anger, rather than from the purpose of his heart. 525 Was the opinion given that my counsels had brought the seer to utter his falsehoods? 527 Such things were said —I do not know with what meaning. 529 And was this charge laid against me with steady eyes and steady mind? 530 I do not know. I see not what my masters do. But here comes our lord from the house. 532 You, how did you get here? Are you so boldfaced that you have come to my house, you who are manifestly the murderer of its master, 535 the palpable thief of its crown? Come, tell me, in the name of the gods, was it cowardice or folly which you saw in me and which led you to plot this thing? Did you think that I would not notice this deed of yours creeping upon me by stealth, or that if I became aware of it I would not ward it off? 540 Is your attempt not foolish, to seek the

	περᾷ. 532 οὗτος σύ, πῶς δεῦρ’ ἦλθες; ἦ τοσόνδ’ ἔχεις 533 τόλμης πρόσωπον ὥστε τὰς ἐμὰς στέγας 534 ἵκου, φονεὺς ὢν τοῦδε τἀνδρὸς ἐμφανῶς 535 λῃστής τ’ ἐναργὴς τῆς ἐμῆς τυραννίδος; 536 φέρ’ εἰπὲ πρὸς θεῶν, δειλίαν ἢ μωρίαν 537 ἰδών τιν’ ἔν μοι ταῦτ’ ἐβουλεύσω ποεῖν; 538 ἢ τοὔργον ὡς οὐ γνωριοῖμί σου τόδε 539 δόλῳ προσέρπον ἢ οὐκ ἀλεξοίμην μαθών; 540 ἆρ’ οὐχὶ μῶρόν ἐστι τοὐγχείρημά σου, 541 ἄνευ τε πλήθους καὶ φίλων τυραννίδα 542 θηρᾶν, ὃ πλήθει χρήμασίν θ’ ἁλίσκεται;	throne without followers or friends—a prize which followers and wealth must win? 543 Mark me now: hear a fair reply in answer to your words, and then judge for yourself on the basis of knowledge. 545 You are apt in speech, but I have a poor wit for lessons, since I have found you a malignant foe. 547 Now hear first how I will explain this very thing. 548 One thing—that you are not false—do not bother to explain to me. 549 If you think that stubbornness 550 without sense is a virtue, you are not wise. 551 If you think you can wrong a kinsman and escape the penalty, you are not sane. 553 Justly said, I grant you: but tell me what the wrong is that you say you are suffering at my hands. 555 Did you, or did you not, advise me to send for that reverend seer? 557 Even now I am of the same mind. 558 How long is it, then, since Laius . . . 559 Did what? I do not understand. 560 was swept out of sight by deadly violence? 561 The count of years would run far into the past. 562 Did this seer possess this skill in those days? 563 He was wise as now, and held in equal honor. 564 Did he make mention of me at that time? 565 Never, certainly, when I was within hearing. 566 Did you never investigate the murder?
1.543	543 οἶσθ’ ὡς πόησον; ἀντὶ τῶν εἰρημένων 544 ἴσ’ ἀντάκουσον, κᾆτα κρῖν’ αὐτὸς μαθών. 545 λέγειν σὺ δεινός, μανθάνειν δ’ ἐγὼ κακὸς 546 σοῦ· δυσμενῆ γὰρ καὶ βαρύν σ’ ηὕρηκ’ ἐμοί. 547 τοῦτ’ αὐτὸ νῦν μου πρῶτ’ ἄκουσον ὡς ἐρῶ. 548 τοῦτ’ αὐτὸ μή μοι φράζ’, ὅπως οὐκ εἶ κακός. 549 εἴ τοι νομίζεις κτῆμα τὴν αὐθαδίαν 550 εἶναί τι τοῦ νοῦ χωρίς, οὐκ ὀρθῶς φρονεῖς. 551 εἴ τοι νομίζεις ἄνδρα συγγενῆ κακῶς 552 δρῶν οὐχ ὑφέξειν τὴν δίκην, οὐκ εὖ φρονεῖς. 553 ξύμφημί σοι ταῦτ’ ἔνδικ’ εἰρῆσθαι· τὸ δὲ 554 πάθημ’ ὁποῖον φῂς παθεῖν, δίδασκέ με. 555 ἔπειθες ἢ οὐκ ἔπειθες, ὡς χρείη μ’ ἐπὶ	567 Due search we made, of course, though we learned nothing. 568 And how was it that this sage did not tell this story then. 569 I do not know: where I lack insight it is my custom to be silent. 570 This much, at least, you know, and could declare with insight enough. 571 What is that? If I know it, I will not deny it. 572 That, if he had not conferred with you, he would not have named me as Laius’ slayer. 574 If he says this, you know best: but I deem it just 575 to learn from you as much as you have from me now. 576 Learn your fill. I will never be found guilty of the bloodshed. 577 Say, then—have you married my sister? 578 The question allows no denial. 579 And you rule the land as she does, with equal sway. 580 She obtains from me all that she wishes. 581 And do I not rank as a third peer of you two? 582 It is just in this that you are seen to be a false friend. 583 Not so, if you would reason with your heart as I do with mine.

	556 τὸν σεμνόμαντιν ἄνδρα πέμψασθαί τινα; 557 καὶ νῦν ἔθ’ αὐτός εἰμι τῷ βουλεύματι. 558 πόσον τιν’ ἤδη δῆθ’ ὁ Λάϊος χρόνον 559 δέδρακε ποῖον ἔργον; οὐ γὰρ ἐννοῶ. 560 ἄφαντος ἔρρει θανασίμῳ χειρώματι; 561 μακροὶ παλαιοί τ’ ἂν μετρηθεῖεν χρόνοι. 562 τότ’ οὖν ὁ μάντις οὗτος ἦν ἐν τῇ τέχνῃ; 563 σοφός γ’ ὁμοίως κἀξ ἴσου τιμώμενος. 564 ἐμνήσατ’ οὖν ἐμοῦ τι τῷ τότ’ ἐν χρόνῳ; 565 οὔκουν ἐμοῦ γ’ ἐστῶτος οὐδαμοῦ πέλας. 566 ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἔρευναν τοῦ κτανόντος ἔσχετε; 567 παρέσχομεν, πῶς δ’ οὐχί; κοὐκ ἠκούσαμεν. 568 πῶς οὖν τόθ’ οὗτος ὁ σοφὸς οὐκ ηὔδα τάδε; 569 οὐκ οἶδ’· ἐφ’ οἷς γὰρ μὴ φρονῶ σιγᾶν φιλῶ. 570 τοσόνδε γ’ οἶσθα καὶ λέγοις ἂν εὖ φρονῶν. 571 ποῖον τόδ’; εἰ γὰρ οἶδά γ’, οὐκ ἀρνήσομαι. 572 ὀθούνεκ’, εἰ μὴ σοὶ ξυνῆλθε, τάσδ’ ἐμὰς	Weigh this first—whether you think that anyone would 585 choose to rule amid terrors rather than in unruffled peace, granted that he is to have the same powers. Now I, for one, have by nature no yearning to rule as a king rather than to do kingly deeds, and neither does any man I know who has a sound mind. 590 For now I attain all everything from you without fear, but, if I were ruler myself, I would have to do much that went against my own pleasure. How, then, could royalty be sweeter to me to have than painless rule and influence? I am not yet so misguided 595 that I desire other honors than those which bring profit. Now, every man has a greeting for me; now, all that have a request of you crave to speak with me, since in me lies all their hope of success. Why then should I give up these things and take those others? 600 No mind will become false while it is wise. No, I am no lover of such a policy, and if another put it into action, I could never bear to go along with him. And, in proof of this, first go to Pytho, and ask whether I brought a true report of the oracle. 605 Then next, if you have found that I have planned anything in concert with the soothsayer, take and slay me, by the sentence not of one mouth, but of two —by my own no less than yours. But do not assume my guilt on unproven inference. It is not just to judge bad men good at random, 610 or good men bad. I think that casting off a true friend is for a man like casting away the life in his own bosom, which he most loves. You will surely learn about these affairs in time, since time alone reveals a just man. 615 But you can discern a bad man even in one day alone. 616 He has spoken well, my king, for one who is taking care not to fall: those who are quick in counsel are not sure. 618 When the stealthy plotter is moving on me quickly, I, too, must be quick in my counterplot. 620 If I await him in repose, his ends will have been gained, and mine lost. 622 What do you want then? To banish me from the land? 623 Hardly. I desire your death, not your exile, so that I might show what a thing envy is. 625 Are you resolved not to yield or believe? 625a
1.573	573 οὐκ ἄν ποτ’ εἶπε Λαΐου διαφθοράς.	

	574 εἰ μὲν λέγει τάδ’, αὐτὸς οἶσθ’· ἐγὼ δὲ σοῦ 575 μαθεῖν δικαιῶ ταὔθ’ ἅπερ κἀμοῦ σὺ νῦν. 576 ἐκμάνθαν’· οὐ γὰρ δὴ φονεὺς ἁλώσομαι. 577 τί δῆτ’; ἀδελφὴν τὴν ἐμὴν γήμας ἔχεις; 578 ἄρνησις οὐκ ἔνεστιν ὧν ἀνιστορεῖς. 579 ἄρχεις δ’ ἐκείνῃ ταὐτὰ γῆς ἴσον νέμων; 580 ἃν ᾗ θέλουσα πάντ’ ἐμοῦ κομίζεται. 581 οὔκουν ἰσοῦμαι σφῷν ἐγὼ δυοῖν τρίτος; 582 ἐνταῦθα γὰρ δὴ καὶ κακὸς φαίνει φίλος. 583 οὔκ, εἰ διδοίης γ’ ὡς ἐγὼ σαυτῷ λόγον. 584 σκέψαι δὲ τοῦτο πρῶτον, εἴ τιν’ ἂν δοκεῖς 585 ἄρχειν ἐλέσθαι ξὺν φόβοισι μᾶλλον ἢ 586 ἄτρεστον εὔδοντ’, εἰ τά γ’ αὔθ’ ἕξει κράτη. 587 ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν οὔτ’ αὐτὸς ἱμείρων ἔφυν 588 τύραννος εἶναι μᾶλλον ἢ τύραννα δρᾶν, 589 οὔτ’ ἄλλος ὅστις σωφρονεῖν ἐπίσταται. 590 νῦν μὲν γὰρ ἐκ σοῦ πάντ’ ἄνευ φόβου φέρω, 591 εἰ δ’ αὐτὸς ἦρχον, πολλὰ κἂν ἄκων ἔδρων. 592 πῶς δῆτ’ ἐμοὶ τυραννὶς ἡδίων ἔχειν 593 ἀρχῆς ἀλύπου καὶ δυναστείας ἔφυ; 594 οὔπω τοσοῦτον ἡπατημένος κυρῶ 595 ὥστ’ ἄλλα χρῄζειν ἢ τὰ σὺν κέρδει καλά. 596 νῦν πᾶσι χαίρω, νῦν με πᾶς ἀσπάζεται, 597 νῦν οἱ σέθεν χρῄζοντες ἐκκαλοῦσί με· 598 τὸ γὰρ τυχεῖν αὐτοῖσι πᾶν ἐνταῦθ’ ἔνι. 599 πῶς δῆτ’ ἐγὼ κεῖν’ ἂν λάβοιμ’ ἀφεὶς τάδε; 600 οὐκ ἂν γένοιτο νοῦς κακὸς καλῶς φρονῶν. 601 ἀλλ’ οὔτ’ ἐραστὴς τῆσδε τῆς γνώμης ἔφυν 602 οὔτ’ ἂν μετ’ ἄλλου δρῶντος ἂν τλαίην ποτέ.	
1.603	603 καὶ τῶνδ’ ἔλεγχον τοῦτο μὲν Πυθώδ’ ἰὼν	626 No, for I see you are not sane. 626a Sane, at least, in my own interest.

	604 πεύθου τὰ χρησθέντ’ εἰ σαφῶς ἤγγειλά σοι· 605 τοῦτ’ ἄλλ’, ἐάν με τῷ τερασκόπῳ λάβῃς 606 κοινῇ τι βουλεύσαντα, μή μ’ ἁπλῇ κτάνῃς 607 ψήφῳ, διπλῇ δέ, τῇ τ’ ἐμῇ καὶ σῇ, λαβών· 608 γνώμῃ δ’ ἀδήλῳ μή με χωρὶς αἰτιῶ. 609 οὐ γὰρ δίκαιον οὔτε τοὺς κακοὺς μάτην 610 χρηστοὺς νομίζειν οὔτε τοὺς χρηστοὺς κακούς. 611 φίλον γὰρ ἐσθλὸν ἐκβαλεῖν ἴσον λέγω 612 καὶ τὸν παρ’ αὐτῷ βίοτον, ὃν πλεῖστον, φιλεῖ. 613 ἀλλ’ ἐν χρόνῳ γνώσει τάδ’ ἀσφαλῶς, ἐπεὶ 614 χρόνος δίκαιον ἄνδρα δείκνυσιν μόνος· 615 κακὸν δὲ κἂν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ γνοίης μιᾷ. 616 καλῶς ἔλεξεν εὐλαβουμένῳ πεσεῖν, 617 ἄναξ· φρονεῖν γὰρ οἱ ταχεῖς οὐκ ἀσφαλεῖς. 618 ὅταν ταχύς τις οὐπιβουλεύων λάθρᾳ 619 χωρῇ, ταχὺν δεῖ κἀμὲ βουλεύειν πάλιν· 620 εἰ δ’ ἡσυχάζων προσμενῶ, τὰ τοῦδε μὲν 621 πεπραγμέν’ ἔσται, τἀμὰ δ’ ἡμαρτημένα. 622 τί δῆτα χρῄζεις; ἦ με γῆς ἔξω βαλεῖν; 623 ἥκιστα· θνῄσκειν, οὐ φυγεῖν σε βούλομαι. 624 ὡς ἂν προδείξῃς οἷόν ἐστι τὸ φθονεῖν. 625 ὡς οὐχ ὑπείξων οὐδὲ πιστεύσων λέγεις; 625a 626 οὐ γὰρ φρονοῦντά σ’ εὖ βλέπω. 626a τὸ γοῦν ἐμόν. 627 ἀλλ’ ἐξ ἴσου δεῖ κἀμόν. 627a ἀλλ’ ἔφυς κακός. 628 εἰ δὲ ξυνίης μηδέν; 628a ἀρκτέον γ’ ὅμως.	627 But you should be so in mine also. 627a You are false. 628 But if you understand nothing? 628a Still I must rule. 629 Not if you rule badly. 629a Hear him, city of Thebes! 630 The city is mine too, not yours alone. 631 Cease, lords. In good time I see Iocasta coming from the house, with whose help you should resolve your present feud. 634 Misguided men, why have you raised 635 such a foolish argument? Are you not ashamed, while the land is so sick, to stir up troubles of your own? Come, go into the house—and you, Creon, go to yours—and stop making so much of a petty grief. 639 Kinswoman, Oedipus, your husband, 640 wants to do one of two terrible things to me, either to thrust me from the land of my fathers or to arrest and slay me. 642 Yes indeed, for I have caught him, lady, working evil against my person with his wicked craft. 644 May I derive no benefit, 645 but perish accursed, if I have done any of the things of which you charge me. 646 In the name of the gods, believe it, Oedipus, first for the sake of this awful oath to the gods, then for my sake and for the sake of those who stand before you.
1.629	629 οὗτοι κακῶς γ’ ἄρχοντος. 629a ὦ πόλις πόλις. 630 κἀμοὶ πόλεως μέτεστιν, οὐχί σοι μόνῳ. 631 παύσασθ’, ἄνακτες· καιρίαν δ’ ὑμῖν ὁρῶ 632 τήνδ’ ἐκ δόμων στείχουσαν Ἰοκάστην, μεθ’ ἧς 633 τὸ νῦν παρεστὸς νεῖκος εὖ θέσθαι	

	χρεών. 634 τί τὴν ἄβουλον, ὦ ταλαίπωροι, στάσιν 635 γλώσσης ἐπήρασθ’ οὐδ’ ἐπαισχύνεσθε γῆς 636 οὕτω νοσούσης ἴδια κινοῦντες κακά; 637 οὐκ εἶ σύ τ’ οἴκους σύ τε, Κρέων, κατὰ στέγας, 638 καὶ μὴ τὸ μηδὲν ἄλγος εἰς μέγ’ οἴσετε; 639 ὄμαιμε, δεινά μ’ Οἰδίπους ὁ σὸς πόσις 640 δρᾶσαι δικαιοῖ δυοῖν ἀποκρίνας κακοῖν 641 ἢ γῆς ἀπῶσαι πατρίδος ἢ κτεῖναι λαβών. 642 ξύμφημι· δρῶντα γάρ νιν, ὦ γύναι, κακῶς 643 εἴληφα τοὐμὸν σῶμα σὺν τέχνῃ κακῇ. 644 μή νυν ὀναίμην, ἀλλ’ ἀραῖος, εἴ σέ τι 645 δέδρακ’, ὀλοίμην, ὧν ἐπαιτιᾷ με δρᾶν. 646 ὦ πρὸς θεῶν πίστευσον, Οἰδίπους, τάδε, 647 μάλιστα μὲν τόνδ’ ὅρκον αἰδεσθεὶς θεῶν, 648 ἔπειτα κἀμὲ τούσδε θ’ οἳ πάρεισί σοι.	
1.1	649 πιθοῦ θελήσας φρονήσας τ’, ἄναξ, λίσσομαι. 650 τί σοι θέλεις δῆτ’ εἰκάθω; 651 τὸν οὔτε πρὶν νήπιον νῦν τ’ ἐν ὅρκῳ μέγαν καταίδεσαι. 652 οἶσθ’ οὖν ἃ χρῄζεις; 653 οἶδα. 654 φράζε δὴ τί φής. 655 τὸν ἐναγῆ φίλον μήποτ’ ἐν αἰτίᾳ 656 σὺν ἀφανεῖ λόγῳ σ’ ἄτιμον βαλεῖν. 657 εὖ νυν ἐπίστω, ταῦθ’ ὅταν ζητῇς, ἐμοὶ 658 ζητῶν ὄλεθρον ἢ φυγὴν ἐκ τῆσδε γῆς.	
1.2	660 οὐ τὸν πάντων θεῶν θεὸν πρόμον 661 Ἅλιον· ἐπεὶ ἄθεος ἄφιλος ὅ τι πύματον 662 ὀλοίμαν, φρόνησιν εἰ τάνδ’ ἔχω. 665 ἀλλά μοι δυσμόρῳ γᾶ φθινὰς 666 τρύχει ψυχάν, τάδ’ εἰ κακοῖς κακὰ 667 προσάψει τοῖς πάλαι τὰ πρὸς σφῷν. 668 ὁ δ’ οὖν ἴτω, κεἰ χρή με παντελῶς θανεῖν 670 ἢ γῆς ἄτιμον τῆσδ’ ἀπωσθῆναι βίᾳ. 671 τὸ γὰρ σόν, οὐ τὸ τοῦδ’, ἐποικτίρω	

	στόμα 672 ἐλεινόν· οὗτος δ’ ἔνθ’ ἂν ᾖ στυγήσεται. 673 στυγνὸς μὲν εἴκων δῆλος εἶ, βαρὺς δ’, ὅταν 674 θυμοῦ περάσῃς· αἱ δὲ τοιαῦται φύσεις 675 αὑταῖς δικαίως εἰσὶν ἄλγισται φέρειν. 676 οὔκουν μ’ ἐάσεις κἀκτὸς εἶ; 677 πορεύσομαι, 678 σοῦ μὲν τυχὼν ἀγνῶτος, ἐν δὲ τοῖσδ’ ἴσος.	
1.1	679 γύναι, τί μέλλεις κομίζειν δόμων τόνδ’ ἔσω; 680 μαθοῦσά γ’ ἥτις ἡ τύχη. 681 δόκησις ἀγνὼς λόγων ἦλθε, δάπτει δὲ καὶ τὸ μὴ ’ν’δικον. 682 ἀμφοῖν ἀπ’ αὐτοῖν; 683 ναίχι. 684 καὶ τίς ἦν λόγος; 685 ἄλις ἔμοιγ’, ἄλις, γᾶς προπονουμένας, 686 φαίνεται ἔνθ’ ἔληξεν αὐτοῦ μένειν. 687 ὁρᾷς ἵν’ ἥκεις, ἀγαθὸς ὢν γνώμην ἀνήρ, 688 τοὐμὸν παριεὶς καὶ καταμβλύνων κέαρ;	
1.2	690 ὦναξ, εἶπον μὲν οὐχ ἅπαξ μόνον, 691 ἴσθι δὲ παραφρόνιμον, ἄπορον ἐπὶ φρόνιμα 692 πεφάνθαι μ’ ἄν, εἴ σ’ ἐνοσφιζόμαν, 693 ὅς τ’ ἐμὰν γᾶν φίλαν ἐν πόνοις 695 ἀλύουσαν κατ’ ὀρθὸν οὔρισας, 696 τανῦν τ’ εὔπομπος, ἂν γένοιο. 697 πρὸς θεῶν δίδαξον κἄμ’, ἄναξ, ὅτου ποτὲ 698 μῆνιν τοσήνδε πράγματος στήσας ἔχεις.	
1.700	700 ἐρῶ· σὲ γὰρ τῶνδ’ ἐς πλέον, γύναι, σέβω· 701 Κρέοντος, οἷά μοι βεβουλευκὼς ἔχει. 702 λέγ’, εἰ σαφῶς τὸ νεῖκος ἐγκαλῶν ἐρεῖς. 703 φονέα με φησὶ Λαΐου καθεστάναι. 704 αὐτὸς ξυνειδὼς ἢ μαθὼν ἄλλου πάρα; 705 μάντιν μὲν οὖν κακοῦργον εἰσπέμψας, ἐπεὶ 706 τό γ’ εἰς ἑαυτὸν πᾶν ἐλευθεροῖ στόμα. 707 σύ νυν ἀφεὶς σεαυτὸν ὧν λέγεις πέρι 708 ἐμοῦ ’πάκουσον, καὶ μάθ’ οὕνεκ’ ἐστί σοι	700 That I will do, for I honor you, lady, above these men. Creon is the cause, and the plots he has laid against me. 702 Come, tell me how the argument began. 703 He says that I stand guilty of Laius’ blood. 704 On his own knowledge or on hearsay from another? 705 He has made a rascal seer his mouth piece: as for himself, he keeps his lips wholly pure. 707 Then absolve yourself of the things about which you are speaking. Listen to me, and take comfort in learning that nothing of mortal birth shares in the science of the seer. 710 I will give you a pithy proof of this. An oracle came to Laius once—I will not say from Phoebus

	709 βρότειον οὐδὲν μαντικῆς ἔχον τέχνης. 710 φανῶ δέ σοι σημεῖα τῶνδε σύντομα. 711 χρησμὸς γὰρ ἦλθε Λαΐῳ ποτ’, οὐκ ἐρῶ 712 Φοίβου γ’ ἄπ’ αὐτοῦ, τῶν δ’ ὑπηρετῶν ἄπο, 713 ὡς αὐτὸν ἕξοι μοῖρα πρὸς παιδὸς θανεῖν, 714 ὅστις γένοιτ’ ἐμοῦ τε κἀκείνου πάρα. 715 καὶ τὸν μέν, ὥσπερ γ’ ἡ φάτις, ξένοι ποτὲ 716 λῃσταὶ φονεύουσ’ ἐν τριπλαῖς ἀμαξιτοῖς· 717 παιδὸς δὲ βλάστας οὐ διέσχον ἡμέραι 718 τρεῖς, καί νιν ἄρθρα κεῖνος ἐνζεύξας ποδοῖν 719 ἔρριψεν ἄλλων χερσὶν ἄβατον εἰς ὄρος. 720 κἀνταῦθ’ Ἀπόλλων οὔτ’ ἐκεῖνον ἤνυσεν 721 φονέα γενέσθαι πατρὸς οὔτε Λάϊον 722 τὸ δεινὸν οὐφοβεῖτο πρὸς παιδὸς θανεῖν. 723 τοιαῦτα φῆμαι μαντικαὶ διώρισαν, 724 ὧν ἐντρέπου σὺ μηδέν· ὧν γὰρ ἂν θεὸς 725 χρείαν ἐρευνᾷ, ῥᾳδίως αὐτὸς φανεῖ. 726 οἷόν μ’ ἀκούσαντ’ ἀρτίως ἔχει, γύναι, 727 ψυχῆς πλάνημα κἀνακίνησις φρενῶν. 728 ποίας μερίμνης τοῦθ’ ὑποστραφεὶς λέγεις; 729 ἔδοξ’ ἀκοῦσαι σοῦ τόδ’, ὡς ὁ Λάϊος	himself, but from his ministers—saying that he would suffer his doom at the hands of the child to be born to him and me. 715 And Laius—as, at least, the rumor goes—was murdered one day by foreign robbers at a place where the three highways meet. And the child’s birth was not yet three days past, when Laius pinned his ankles together and had him thrown, by others’ hands, on a remote mountain. 720 So, in that case, Apollo did not bring it to pass that the child should become the slayer of his father, or that Laius should suffer that which he feared, death at the hands of his child: thus the messages of the seer’s art had mapped out the future. Pay them no regard. Whatever necessary event 725 the god seeks, he himself will easily bring to light. 726 What restlessness of soul, lady, what tumult has come upon me since I heard you speak! 728 What anxiety has startled you, that you say this? 729 I thought that I heard this from you—that Laius 730 was slain where the three roads meet. 731 Yes, that was the report, and so it is still thought. 732 And where is the place where this occurred? 733 The land is called Phocis; the branching forks lead to the same spot from Delphi and from Daulia. 735 And how much time has passed since these events took place? 736 The news was announced to the town shortly before you first attained power over this land. 738 O Zeus, what have you decreed for me? 739 Why, Oedipus, does this matter weigh upon your heart? 740 Do not ask me yet. Tell me rather what stature Laius had, and how ripe his manhood was. 742 He was tall—the silver just lightly strewn among his hair—and his form was not greatly unlike your own. 744 Unhappy that I am! I think that I have 745 laid myself under a terrible curse without realizing it. 746 How do you mean? I tremble when I look at you, my lord. 747 I have dread fears that the seer can see. But you will reveal the matter better if you tell me one thing more. 749 Indeed, though I tremble, I will hear and answer all that you ask. 750 Did he go with a small force, or like a chieftain, with many armed followers? 753 Five they were in all—a herald among them—and there was one

		carriage which bore Laius.
1.730	730 κατασφαγείη πρὸς τριπλαῖς ἀμαξιτοῖς. 731 ηὐδᾶτο γὰρ ταῦτ’ οὐδέ πω λήξαντ’ ἔχει. 732 καὶ ποῦ ’σθ’ ὁ χῶρος οὗτος οὗ τόδ’ ἦν πάθος; 733 Φωκὶς μὲν ἡ γῆ κλῄζεται, σχιστὴ δ’ ὁδὸς 734 ἐς ταὐτὸ Δελφῶν κἀπὸ Δαυλίας ἄγει. 735 καὶ τίς χρόνος τοῖσδ’ ἐστὶν οὐξεληλυθώς; 736 σχεδόν τι πρόσθεν ἢ σὺ τῆσδ’ ἔχων χθονὸς 737 ἀρχὴν ἐφαίνου, τοῦτ’ ἐκηρύχθη πόλει. 738 ὦ Ζεῦ, τί μου δρᾶσαι βεβούλευσαι πέρι; 739 τί δ’ ἐστί σοι τοῦτ’, Οἰδίπους, ἐνθύμιον; 740 μήπω μ’ ἐρώτα· τὸν δὲ Λάϊον φύσιν 741 τίν’ ἦλθε φράζε, τίνα δ’ ἀκμὴν ἥβης ἔχων. 742 μέγας, χνοάζων ἄρτι λευκανθὲς κάρα, 743 μορφῆς δὲ τῆς σῆς οὐκ ἀπεστάτει πολύ. 744 οἴμοι τάλας· ἔοικ’ ἐμαυτὸν εἰς ἀρὰς 745 δεινὰς προβάλλων ἀρτίως οὐκ εἰδέναι. 746 πῶς φῄς; ὀκνῶ τοι πρός σ’ ἀποσκοποῦσ’, ἄναξ. 747 δεινῶς ἀθυμῶ μὴ βλέπων ὁ μάντις ᾖ· 748 δείξεις δὲ μᾶλλον, ἢν ἓν ἐξείπῃς ἔτι. 749 καὶ μὴν ὀκνῶ μέν, ἃ δ’ ἂν ἔρῃ μαθοῦσ’ ἐρῶ. 750 πότερον ἐχώρει βαιὸς ἢ πολλοὺς ἔχων 751 ἄνδρας λοχίτας, οἷ’ ἀνὴρ ἀρχηγέτης; 752 πέντ’ ἦσαν οἱ ξύμπαντες, ἐν δ’ αὐτοῖσιν ἦν . 753 κῆρυξ· ἀπήνη δ’ ἦγε Λάϊον μία. 754 αἰαῖ, τάδ’ ἤδη διαφανῆ. τίς ἦν ποτε 755 ὁ τούσδε λέξας τοὺς λόγους ὑμῖν, γύναι; 756 οἰκεύς τις, ὅσπερ ἵκετ’ ἐκσωθεὶς μόνος. 757 ἦ κἀν δόμοισι τυγχάνει τανῦν παρών; 758 οὐ δῆτ’· ἀφ’ οὗ γὰρ κεῖθεν ἦλθε καὶ κράτη 759 σέ τ’ εἶδ’ ἔχοντα Λάϊόν τ’ ὀλωλότα,	755 Alas! It is all clear now! Who gave you this information, lady? 756 A servant, the only survivor who returned home. 757 Is he by any chance in the house now? 758 No. Soon after he returned and found you ruling in Laius’ stead, 760 he pled with me, with hand laid on mine, to send him to the fields, to the pastures of the flocks, that he might be far from the sight of this town. And I sent him; he was worthy, for a slave, to win even a larger favor than that. 765 Would, then, that he return to us without delay! 766 That is easy. But why do you enjoin this? 767 I fear, lady, that my words have been rash, and therefore I wish to see him. 769 He will come. But I think that 770 I too have a claim to learn what lies heavy on your heart, my king. 771 It will not be kept from you, now that my forebodings have advanced so far. To whom more than to you would I speak in suffering such a fortune as this? My father was Polybus of Corinth, 775 my mother the Dorian Merope. I was considered the greatest of the folk in that town, until a chance event befell me, worthy, indeed, of wonder, though not of my overreaction regarding it. At a banquet, a man drunk with wine 780 cast it at me that I was not the true son of my father. And I, vexed, restrained myself for that day as best as I could, but on the next went to my mother and father and questioned them. They were angry at the one who had let this taunt fly. 785 So I had comfort about them, but the matter rankled in my heart, for such a rumor still spread widely. I went to Delphi without my parents’ knowledge, and Phoebus sent me forth disappointed of the knowledge for which I had come, 790 but in his response set forth other things, full of sorrow and terror and woe: that I was fated to defile my mother’s bed, that I would reveal to men a brood which they could not endure to behold, and that I would slay the father that sired me. When I heard this, I turned in flight from the land of Corinth, 795 from then on thinking of it only by its position under the stars, to some spot where I should never see fulfillment of the infamies foretold in my evil fate. And on my way I came to the land in which

		you say that this prince perished. 800 Now, lady, I will tell you the truth. When on my journey I was near those three roads, there I met a herald, and a man in a carriage drawn by colts, as you have described. The leader and the old man 805 himself tried to thrust me rudely from the path. Then, in anger, I struck the one pushing me aside, the driver, and the old man, when he saw this, watched for the moment I was passing, and from his carriage, brought his double goad straight down on my head. 810 Yet he was paid back with interest: with one swift blow from the staff in this hand he rolled right out of the carriage onto his back. I slew every one of them. But if this stranger had any tie of kinship to Laius, 815 who is now more wretched than this man before you? What mortal could be proved more hateful to the gods? No stranger, no citizen, is allowed to receive him at home, it is unlawful for anyone to accost him, and all must push him from their homes. And this— this curse— 820 was laid on me by no other mouth than my own. And I pollute the bed of the slain man with the hands by which he perished. Am I now vile? Oh, am I not utterly unclean, seeing that I must be banished, and in banishment neither see my own people, 825 nor set foot in my own land, or else be joined in wedlock to my mother, and slay my father Polybus, who sired and reared me? Then would he who judged these things to be sent down by some cruel divinity not be right about Oedipus? 830 Prevent, prevent, you pure and awful gods, me from ever seeing that day! No, may I be swept away from all men, before I see myself visited with that brand of doom. 834 To us, king, these things are fraught with fear. Yet have hope, until at least you have gained full knowledge 835 from the one who saw the deed. 836 I have, in truth, this much hope alone: I await the man summoned from the pastures. 838 And what do you want from him when he appears? 839 I will tell you. If his story is found 840 to match withwith yours, I at least, will stand clear of disaster. 841 And what special note did you hear from me?
1.760	760 ἐξικέτευσε τῆς ἐμῆς χειρὸς θιγὼν 761 ἀγρούς σφε πέμψαι κἀπὶ ποιμνίων	

	νομάς, 762 ὡς πλεῖστον εἴη τοῦδ’ ἄποπτος ἄστεως. 763 κἄπεμψ’ ἐγώ νιν· ἄξιος γὰρ οἶ’ ἀνὴρ 764 δοῦλος φέρειν ἦν τῆσδε καὶ μείζω χάριν. 765 πῶς ἂν μόλοι δῆθ’ ἡμὶν ἐν τάχει πάλιν; 766 πάρεστιν· ἀλλὰ πρὸς τί τοῦτ’ ἐφίεσαι; 767 δέδοικ’ ἐμαυτόν, ὦ γύναι, μὴ πόλλ’ ἄγαν 768 εἰρημέν’ ᾖ μοι δι’ ἃ νιν εἰσιδεῖν θέλω. 769 ἀλλ’ ἵξεται μέν· ἀξία δέ που μαθεῖν 770 κἀγὼ τά γ’ ἐν σοὶ δυσφόρως ἔχοντ’, ἄναξ. 771 κοὐ μὴ στερηθῇς γ’, ἐς τοσοῦτον ἐλπίδων 772 ἐμοῦ βεβῶτος. τῷ γὰρ ἂν καὶ μείζονι 773 λέξαιμ’ ἂν ἢ σοί, διὰ τύχης τοιᾶσδ’ ἰών; 774 ἐμοὶ πατὴρ μὲν Πόλυβος ἦν Κορίνθιος, 775 μήτηρ δὲ Μερόπη Δωρίς. ἠγόμην δ’ ἀνὴρ 776 ἀστῶν μέγιστος τῶν ἐκεῖ, πρίν μοι τύχη 777 τοιάδ’ ἐπέστη, θαυμάσαι μὲν ἀξία, 778 σπουδῆς γε μέντοι τῆς ἐμῆς οὐκ ἀξία. 779 ἀνὴρ γὰρ ἐν δείπνοις μ’ ὑπερπλησθεὶς μέθῃ 780 καλεῖ παρ’ οἴνῳ, πλαστὸς ὡς εἴην πατρί. 781 κἀγὼ βαρυνθεὶς τὴν μὲν οὖσαν ἡμέραν 782 μόλις κατέσχον, θἀτέρᾳ δ’ ἰὼν πέλας 783 μητρὸς πατρός τ’ ἤλεγχον· οἱ δὲ δυσφόρως 784 τοὔνειδος ἦγον τῷ μεθέντι τὸν λόγον. 785 κἀγὼ τὰ μὲν κείνοιν ἐτερπόμην, ὅμως δ’ 786 ἔκνιζέ μ’ ἀεὶ τοῦθ’· ὑφεῖρπε γὰρ πολύ. 787 λάθρᾳ δὲ μητρὸς καὶ πατρὸς πορεύομαι 788 Πυθώδε, καί μ’ ὁ Φοῖβος ὧν μὲν ἱκόμην 789 ἄτιμον ἐξέπεμψεν, ἄλλα δ’ ἄθλια	
1.790	790 καὶ δεινὰ καὶ δύστηνα προύφηνεν λέγων, 791 ὡς μητρὶ μὲν χρείη με μιχθῆναι,	

	γένος δ’ 792 ἄτλητον ἀνθρώποισι δηλώσοιμ’ ὁρᾶν, 793 φονεὺς δ’ ἐσοίμην τοῦ φυτεύσαντος πατρός. 794 κἀγὼ ’πακούσας ταῦτα τὴν Κορινθίαν, 795 ἄστροις τὸ λοιπὸν ἐκμετρούμενος, χθόνα 796 ἔφευγον, ἔνθα μήποτ’ ὀψοίμην κακῶν 797 χρησμῶν ὀνείδη τῶν ἐμῶν τελούμενα. 798 στείχων δ’ ἱκνοῦμαι τούσδε τοὺς χώρους, ἐν οἷς 799 σὺ τὸν τύραννον τοῦτον ὄλλυσθαι λέγεις. 800 καί σοι, γύναι, τἀληθὲς ἐξερῶ. τριπλῆς 801 ὅτ’ ἦ κελεύθου τῆσδ’ ὁδοιπορῶν πέλας, 802 ἐνταῦθά μοι κῆρύξ τε κἀπὶ πωλικῆς 803 ἀνὴρ ἀπήνης ἐμβεβώς, οἷον σὺ φῄς, 804 ξυνηντίαζον· κἀξ ὁδοῦ μ’ ὅ θ’ ἡγεμὼν 805 αὐτός θ’ ὁ πρέσβυς πρὸς βίαν ἠλαυνέτην. 806 κἀγὼ τὸν ἐκτρέποντα, τὸν τροχηλάτην, 807 παίω δι’ ὀργῆς· καί μ’ ὁ πρέσβυς ὡς ὁρᾷ, 808 ὄχου παραστείχοντα τηρήσας, μέσον 809 κάρα διπλοῖς κέντροισί μου καθίκετο. 810 οὐ μὴν ἴσην γ’ ἔτισεν, ἀλλὰ συντόμως 811 σκήπτρῳ τυπεὶς ἐκ τῆσδε χειρὸς ὕπτιος 812 μέσης ἀπήνης εὐθὺς ἐκκυλίνδεται· 813 κτείνω δὲ τοὺς ξύμπαντας. εἰ δὲ τῷ ξένῳ 814 τούτῳ προσήκει Λαΐου τι συγγενές, 815 τίς τοῦδέ γ’ ἀνδρός ἐστιν ἀθλιώτερος; 816 τίς ἐχθροδαίμων μᾶλλον ἂν γένοιτ’ ἀνήρ; 817 ὃν μὴ ξένων ἔξεστι μηδ’ ἀστῶν τινι 818 δόμοις δέχεσθαι μηδὲ προσφωνεῖν τινα, 819 ὠθεῖν δ’ ἀπ’ οἴκων. καὶ τάδ’ οὔτις ἄλλος ἦν	
1.820	820 ἢ ’γὼ ’π’ ἐμαυτῷ τάσδ’ ἀρὰς ὁ προστιθείς. 821 λέχη δὲ τοῦ θανόντος ἐκ χεροῖν	842 You said that he spoke of Laius as slain by robbers. If, then, he still speaks of several as before, I was not

	ἐμαῖν 822 χραίνω, δι’ ὧνπερ ὤλετ’· ἆρ’ ἔφυν κακός; 823 ἆρ’ οὐχὶ πᾶς ἄναγνος; εἴ με χρὴ φυγεῖν, 824 καί μοι φυγόντι μἤστι τοὺς ἐμοὺς ἰδεῖν 825 μηδ’ ἐμβατεύειν πατρίδος, ἢ γάμοις με δεῖ 826 μητρὸς ζυγῆναι καὶ πατέρα κατακτανεῖν 827 Πόλυβον, ὃς ἐξέφυσε κἀξέθρεψέ με. 828 ἆρ’ οὐκ ἀπ’ ὠμοῦ ταῦτα δαίμονός τις ἂν 829 κρίνων ἐπ’ ἀνδρὶ τῷδ’ ἂν ὀρθοίη λόγον; 830 μὴ δῆτα, μὴ δῆτ’, ὦ θεῶν ἁγνὸν σέβας, 831 ἴδοιμι ταύτην ἡμέραν, ἀλλ’ ἐκ βροτῶν 832 βαίην ἄφαντος πρόσθεν ἢ τοιάνδ’ ἰδεῖν 833 κηλῖδ’ ἐμαυτῷ συμφορᾶς ἀφιγμένην. 834 ἡμῖν μέν, ὦναξ, ταῦτ’ ὀκνήρ’· ἕως δ’ ἂν οὖν 835 πρὸς τοῦ παρόντος ἐκμάθῃς, ἔχ’ ἐλπίδα. 836 καὶ μὴν τοσοῦτόν γ’ ἐστί μοι τῆς ἐλπίδος, 837 τὸν ἄνδρα τὸν βοτῆρα προσμεῖναι μόνον. 838 πεφασμένου δὲ τίς ποθ’ ἡ προθυμία; 839 ἐγὼ διδάξω σ’· ἦν γὰρ εὑρεθῇ λέγων 840 σοὶ ταὔτ’, ἔγωγ’ ἂν ἐκπεφευγοίην πάθος. 841 ποῖον δέ μου περισσὸν ἤκουσας λόγον; 842 λῃστὰς ἔφασκες αὐτὸν ἄνδρας ἐννέπειν 843 ὥς νιν κατακτείνειαν. εἰ μὲν οὖν ἔτι 844 λέξει τὸν αὐτὸν ἀριθμόν, οὐκ ἐγὼ ’κτανον· 845 οὐ γὰρ γένοιτ’ ἂν εἷς γε τοῖς πολλοῖς ἴσος· 846 εἰ δ’ ἄνδρ’ ἔν’ οἰόζωνον αὐδήσει, σαφῶς 847 τοῦτ’ ἐστὶν ἤδη τοὔργον εἰς ἐμὲ ῥέπον. 848 ἀλλ’ ὡς φανέν γε τοὔπος ὦδ’ ἐπίστασο, 849 κοὐκ ἔστιν αὐτῷ τοῦτό γ’ ἐκβαλεῖν πάλιν·	the slayer: 845 a solitary man could not be considered the same as that band. But if he names one lonely wayfarer, then beyond doubt this guilt rests upon me. 848 Be assured that thus, at least, the tale was first told. He cannot revoke that, 850 for the city heard it, not I alone. But even if he should diverge somewhat from his former story, never, king, can he show that the murder of Laius, at least, is truly square with the prophecy, for Loxias plainly said that he was to die at the hand of my child. 855 How was it then that that poor innocent never slew him, but perished first? From now on then, as far as divination goes, I would not look to my right hand or my left. 859 You are right. But nevertheless send someone to fetch the peasant, 860 and do not neglect this matter. 861 I will send for him without delay. But let us go into the house: I will do nothing which does not please you. Exeunt Oedipus and Iocasta.
1.850	850 πόλις γὰρ ἤκουσ’, οὐκ ἐγὼ μόνη,	

	τάδε. 851 εἰ δ’ οὖν τι κἀκτρέποιτο τοῦ πρόσθεν λόγου, 852 οὔτοι ποτ’, ὦναξ, σόν γε Λαΐου φόνον 853 φανεῖ δικαίως ὀρθόν, ὅν γε Λοξίας 854 διεῖπε χρῆναι παιδὸς ἐξ ἐμοῦ θανεῖν. 855 καίτοι νιν οὐ κεῖνός γ’ ὁ δύστηνός ποτε 856 κατέκταν’, ἀλλ’ αὐτὸς πάροιθεν ὤλετο. 857 ὥστ’ οὐχὶ μαντείας γ’ ἂν οὔτε τῇδ’ ἐγὼ 858 βλέψαιμ’ ἂν εἵνεκ’ οὔτε τῇδ’ ἂν ὕστερον. 859 καλῶς νομίζεις· ἀλλ’ ὅμως τὸν ἐργάτην 860 πέμψον τινὰ στελοῦντα μηδὲ τοῦτ’ ἀφῇς. 861 πέμψω ταχύνασ’· ἀλλ’ ἴωμεν ἐς δόμους· 862 οὐδὲν γὰρ ἂν πράξαιμ’ ἂν ὧν οὐ σοὶ φίλον.	
1.1	863 εἴ μοι ξυνείη φέροντι 864 μοῖρα τὰν εὔσεπτον ἁγνείαν λόγων 865 ἔργων τε πάντων, ὧν νόμοι πρόκεινται 866 ὑψίποδες, οὐρανίαν 867 δι’ αἰθέρα τεκνωθέντες, ὧν Ὄλυμπος 868 πατὴρ μόνος, οὐδέ νιν 869 θνατὰ φύσις ἀνέρων 870 ἔτικτεν οὐδὲ μή ποτε λάθα κατακοιμάσῃ· 871 μέγας ἐν τούτοις θεὸς οὐδὲ γηράσκει.	
1.1	873 ὕβρις φυτεύει τύραννον· 874 ὕβρις, εἰ πολλῶν ὑπερπλησθῇ μάταν, 875 ἃ μὴ ’πίκαιρα μηδὲ συμφέροντα, 876 ἀκρότατον εἰσαναβᾶσ’ 877 αἶπος ἀπότομον ὤρουσεν εἰς ἀνάγκαν, 878 ἔνθ’ οὐ ποδὶ χρησίμῳ 880 χρῆται. τὸ καλῶς δ’ ἔχον 881 πόλει πάλαισμα μήποτε λῦσαι θεὸν αἰτοῦμαι. 882 θεὸν οὐ λήξω ποτὲ προστάταν ἴσχων.	
1.2	884 εἰ δέ τις ὑπέροπτα χερσὶν ἢ λόγῳ πορεύεται, 885 δίκας ἀφόβητος οὐδὲ δαιμόνων ἕδη σέβων, 886 κακά νιν ἕλοιτο μοῖρα,	

	887 δυσπότμου χάριν χλιδᾶς, 888 εἰ μὴ τὸ κέρδος κερδανεῖ δικαίως 890 καὶ τῶν ἀσέπτων ἔρξεται 891 ἢ τῶν ἀθίκτων θίξεται ματάζων. 892 τίς ἔτι ποτ’ ἐν τοῖσδ’ ἀνὴρ θεῶν βέλη 893 εὔξεται ψυχᾶς ἀμύνειν; 895 εἰ γὰρ αἱ τοιαίδε πράξεις τίμιαι, 896 τί δεῖ με χορεύειν;	
1.2	897 οὐκέτι τὸν ἄθικτον εἶμι γᾶς ἐπ’ ὀμφαλὸν σέβων, 900 οὐδ’ ἐς τὸν Ἀβαῖσι ναὸν οὐδὲ τὰν Ὀλυμπίαν, 901 εἰ μὴ τάδε χειρόδεικτα 902 πᾶσιν ἁρμόσει βροτοῖς. 903 ἀλλ’, ὦ κρατύνων, εἴπερ ὄρθ’ ἀκούεις, 905 Ζεῦ, πάντ’ ἀνάσσων, μὴ λάθοι 906 σὲ τάν τε σὰν ἀθάνατον αἰὲν ἀρχάν. 907 φθίνοντα γὰρ Λαΐου παλαίφατα 908 θέσφατ’ ἐξαιροῦσιν ἤδη, 909 κοὐδαμοῦ τιμαῖς Ἀπόλλων ἐμφανής· 910 ἔρρει δὲ τὰ θεῖα.	
1.911	911 χώρας ἄνακτες, δόξα μοι παρεστάθη 912 ναοὺς ἱκέσθαι δαιμόνων, τάδ’ ἐν χεροῖν 913 στέφη λαβούσῃ κἀπιθυμιάματα. 914 ὑψοῦ γὰρ αἴρει θυμὸν Οἰδίπους ἄγαν 915 λύπαισι παντοίαισιν· οὐδ’ ὁποῖ’ ἀνὴρ 916 ἔννους τὰ καινὰ τοῖς πάλαι τεκμαίρεται, 917 ἀλλ’ ἐστὶ τοῦ λέγοντος, εἰ φόβους λέγοι. 918 ὅτ’ οὖν παραινοῦσ’ οὐδὲν ἐς πλέον ποιῶ, 919 πρὸς σ’, ὦ Λύκει’ Ἄπολλον, ἄγχιστος γὰρ εἶ, 920 ἱκέτις ἀφῖγμαι τοῖσδε σὺν κατεύγμασιν, 921 ὅπως λύσιν τιν’ ἡμὶν εὐαγῆ πόρῃς· 922 ὡς νῦν ὁκνοῦμεν πάντες ἐκπεπληγμένον 923 κεῖνον βλέποντες ὡς κυβερνήτην νεώς. 924 ἆρ’ ἂν παρ’ ὑμῶν, ὦ ξένοι, μάθοιμ’ ὅπου 925 τὰ τοῦ τυράννου δώματ’ ἐστὶν Οἰδίπου; 926 μάλιστα δ’ αὐτὸν εἴπατ’, εἰ κάτισθ’ ὅπου. 927 στέγαι μὲν αἵδε, καὐτὸς ἔνδον, ὦ ξένε·	911 Princes of the land, I am planning to visit the shrines of the gods, with this wreathed branch and these gifts of incense in my hands. For Oedipus excites his soul excessively with all sorts of grief, 915 as he does not judge the new things from the old, like a man of sense, but is under the control of the speaker, if he speaks of frightful things. Since, then, I can do no good by counsel, to you, Lycean Apollo—for you are nearest— 920 I have come as a suppliant with these symbols of prayer, that you may find us some escape from uncleanliness. For now we are all afraid, like those who see fear in the helmsman of their ship. 924 Can you tell me, strangers, where 925 the house of King Oedipus is? Or better still, tell me where he himself is, if you know. 927 This is his dwelling, and he himself, stranger, is within. This lady here is the mother of his children. 929 Then may she be ever happy in a happy home, 930 since she is his blessed queen. 931 Happiness to you also, stranger! Your fair greeting deserves this. But say what you have come to seek or to tell. 934 Good tidings, lady, for your house and your husband. 935 What are they? From whom have you come? 936 From Corinth, and at the

	928 γυνὴ δὲ μήτηρ ἥδε τῶν κείνου τέκνων. 929 ἀλλ’ ὀλβία τε καὶ ξὺν ὀλβίοις ἀεὶ 930 γένοιτ’, ἐκείνου γ’ οὖσα παντελὴς δάμαρ. 931 αὖτως δὲ καὶ σύ γ’, ὦ ξέν’· ἄξιος γὰρ εἶ 932 τῆς εὐεπείας εἵνεκ’· ἀλλὰ φράζ’ ὅτου 933 χρῄζων ἀφῖξαι χὤ τι σημῆναι θέλων. 934 ἀγαθὰ δόμοις τε καὶ πόσει τῷ σῷ, γύναι. 935 τὰ ποῖα ταῦτα; παρὰ τίνος δ’ ἀφιγμένος; 936 ἐκ τῆς Κορίνθου· τὸ δ’ ἔπος οὐξερῶ τάχα, 937 ἥδοιο μέν, πῶς δ’ οὐκ ἄν, ἀσχάλλοις δ’ ἴσως. 938 τί δ’ ἔστι; ποίαν δύναμιν ὧδ’ ἔχει διπλῆν; 939 τύραννον αὐτὸν οὐπιχώριοι χθονὸς 940 τῆς Ἰσθμίας στήσουσιν, ὡς ηὐδᾶτ’ ἐκεῖ.	message I will give now you will doubtless rejoice, though you may perhaps grieve too. 938 What is it? Why has it this double potency? 939 The people will make him king of the 940 Isthmian land, as it was said there. 941 How then? Is the aged Polybus no longer in power? 942 No. For death holds him in the tomb. 943 What do you mean? Is Polybus dead, old man? 944 If I do not speak the truth, I am content to die. 945 Handmaid, away with all speed, and tell this to your master! Oracles of the gods, where do you stand now? It is this man that Oedipus long feared he would slay. And now this man has died in the course of destiny, not by his hand. 950 Iocasta, dearest wife, why have you summoned me forth from these doors? 952 Hear this man, and judge, as you listen, what the awful oracles have come to. 954 Who is he and what news does he have for me? 955 He comes from Corinth to tell you that your father Polybus lives no longer, but has perished. 957 How, stranger? Let me have it from your own mouth. 958 If I must first make these tidings plain, know indeed that he is dead and gone. 960 By treachery, or from illness? 961 A light tilt of the scale brings the aged to their rest. 962 Ah, he died, it seems, of sickness? 963 Yes, and of the long years that he had lived.
1.941	941 τί δ’; οὐχ ὁ πρέσβυς Πόλυβος ἐγκρατὴς ἔτι; 942 οὐ δῆτ’, ἐπεί νιν θάνατος ἐν τάφοις ἔχει. 943 πῶς εἶπας; ἦ τέθνηκε Πόλυβος, ὦ γέρον; 944 εἰ μὴ λέγω τἀληθές, ἀξιῶ θανεῖν. 945 ὦ πρόσπολ’, οὐχὶ δεσπότῃ τάδ’ ὡς τάχος 946 μολοῦσα λέξεις; ὦ θεῶν μαντεύματα, 947 ἵν’ ἐστέ· τοῦτον Οἰδίπους πάλαι τρέμων 948 τὸν ἄνδρ’ ἔφευγε μὴ κτάνοι, καὶ νῦν ὅδε 949 πρὸς τῆς τύχης ὄλωλεν οὐδὲ τοῦδ’ ὕπο. 950 ὦ φίλτατον γυναικὸς Ἰοκάστης κάρα, 951 τί μ’ ἐξεπέμψω δεῦρο τῶνδε δωμάτων; 952 ἄκουε τἀνδρὸς τοῦδε, καὶ σκόπει κλύων 953 τὰ σέμν’ ἵν’ ἥκει τοῦ θεοῦ	964 Alas, alas! Why indeed, my wife, should one look to the 965 hearth of the Pythian seer, or to the birds that scream above our heads, who declared that I was doomed to slay my father? But he is dead, and lies beneath the earth, and here I am, not having put my hand to any spear—unless, perhaps, he died out of longing for me: 970 thus, indeed, I would be the cause of his death. But as the oracles stand, at least, Polybus has swept them with him to his rest in Hades. They are worth nothing. 973 Did I not long ago foretell this to you? 974 You did, but I was mislead by my fear. 975 Now no longer take any of those things to heart. 976 But surely I must fear my mother’s bed. 977 What should a mortal man fear, for whom the decrees of Fortune are supreme, and who has clear foresight of nothing? It is best to live at random, as one may. 980 But fear not that you will wed your mother. Many men

	μαντεύματα. 954 οὗτος δὲ τίς ποτ’ ἐστὶ καὶ τί μοι λέγει; 955 ἐκ τῆς Κορίνθου, πατέρα τὸν σὸν ἀγγελῶν 956 ὡς οὐκέτ’ ὄντα Πόλυβον, ἀλλ’ ὀλωλότα. 957 τί φῄς, ξέν’; αὐτός μοι σὺ σημάντωρ γενοῦ. 958 εἰ τοῦτο πρῶτον δεῖ μ’ ἀπαγγεῖλαι σαφῶς, 959 εὖ ἴσθ’ ἐκεῖνον θανάσιμον βεβηκότα. 960 πότερα δόλοισιν ἢ νόσου ξυναλλαγῇ; 961 σμικρὰ παλαιὰ σώματ’ εὐνάζει ῥοπή. 962 νόσοις ὁ τλήμων, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἔφθιτο. 963 καὶ τῷ μακρῷ γε συμμετρούμενος χρόνῳ. 964 φεῦ φεῦ, τί δῆτ’ ἄν, ὦ γύναι, σκοποῖτό τι 965 τὴν Πυθόμαντιν ἑστίαν ἢ τοὺς ἄνω 966 κλάζοντας ὄρνεις, ὧν ὑφηγητῶν ἐγὼ 967 κτενεῖν ἔμελλον πατέρα τὸν ἐμόν; ὁ δὲ θανὼν 968 κεύθει κάτω δὴ γῆς. ἐγὼ δ’ ὅδ’ ἐνθάδε 969 ἄψαυστος ἔγχους· εἴ τι μὴ τὼμῷ πόθῳ 970 κατέφθιθ’· οὕτω δ’ ἂν θανὼν εἴη ’ξ ἐμοῦ.	before now have slept with their mothers in dreams. But he to whom these things are as though nothing bears his life most easily. 984 All these words of yours would have been well said, 985 were my mother not alive. But as it is, since she lives, I must necessarily fear, though you do speak well. 987 Your father’s death is a great sign for us to take cheer. 988 Great, I know. But my fear is of her who lives. 989 And who is the woman about whom you fear? 990 Merope, old man, the consort of Polybus. 991 And what is it in her that moves your fear? 992 A divine oracle of dread import, stranger. 993 Proper, or improper, for another to know? 994 Proper, surely. Loxias once said that I was 995 doomed to marry my own mother, and to shed with my own hands my father’s blood. For which reasons I long shirked my home in Corinth—with a happy outcome, to be sure, but still it is sweet to see the face of one’s parents. 999 Was it really for fear of this that you became an exile from that city? 1000 And because I did not wish, old man, to be the murderer of my father. 1001 Why have I not relieved you of this second fear, my lord, since I came to give you pleasure? 1002 And indeed you will have worthy thanks from me. 1004 And indeed I came specially for this, that 1005 I might profit from your returning home. 1007 But by no means will I ever go near my parents again. 1008 My son, it is crystal clear that you do not know what you are doing. 1009 How so, old man? In the name of the gods, tell me. 1010 If on account of this you are fleeing from returning home.
1.971	971 τὰ δ’ οὖν παρόντα συλλαβὼν θεσπίσματα 972 κεῖται παρ’ Ἅιδῃ Πόλυβος ἄξι’ οὐδενός. 973 οὔκουν ἐγώ σοι ταῦτα προύλεγον πάλαι; 974 ηὔδας· ἐγὼ δὲ τῷ φόβῳ παρηγόμην. 975 μὴ νῦν ἔτ’ αὐτῶν μηδὲν ἐς θυμὸν βάλῃς. 976 καὶ πῶς τὸ μητρὸς οὐκ ὀκνεῖν λέχος με δεῖ; 977 τί δ’ ἂν φοβοῖτ’ ἄνθρωπος ᾧ τὰ τῆς τύχης 978 κρατεῖ, πρόνοια δ’ ἐστὶν οὐδενὸς σαφής; 979 εἰκῆ κράτιστον ζῆν, ὅπως δύναιτό	

	τις. 980 σὺ δ’ εἰς τὰ μητρὸς μὴ φοβοῦ νυμφεύματα· 981 πολλοὶ γὰρ ἤδη κἀν ὀνείρασιν βροτῶν 982 μητρὶ ξυνηυνάσθησαν. ἀλλὰ ταῦθ’ ὅτῳ 983 παρ’ οὐδέν ἐστι, ῥᾷστα τὸν βίον φέρει. 984 καλῶς ἅπαντα ταῦτ’ ἂν ἐξείρητό σοι, 985 εἰ μὴ ’κύρει ζῶσ’ ἡ τεκοῦσα· νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ 986 ζῇ, πᾶσ’ ἀνάγκη, κεἰ καλῶς λέγεις, ὀκνεῖν. 987 καὶ μὴν μέγας γ’ ὀφθαλμὸς οἱ πατρὸς τάφοι. 988 μέγας, ξυνίημ’· ἀλλὰ τῆς ζώσης φόβος. 989 ποίας δὲ καὶ γυναικὸς ἐκφοβεῖσθ’ ὕπερ; 990 Μερόπης, γεραιέ, Πόλυβος ἧς ᾤκει μέτα. 991 τί δ’ ἔστ’ ἐκείνης ὑμὶν ἐς φόβον φέρον; 992 θεήλατον μάντευμα δεινόν, ὦ ξένε. 993 ἦ ῥητόν; ἢ οὐχὶ θεμιτὸν ἄλλον εἰδέναι; 994 μάλιστά γ’· εἶπε γάρ με Λοξίας ποτὲ 995 χρῆναι μιγῆναι μητρὶ τἠμαυτοῦ τό τε 996 πατρῷον αἷμα χερσὶ ταῖς ἐμαῖς ἑλεῖν. 997 ὧν οὕνεχ’ ἡ Κόρινθος ἐξ ἐμοῦ πάλαι 998 μακρὰν ἀπῳκεῖτ’· εὐτυχῶς μέν, ἀλλ’ ὅμως 999 τὰ τῶν τεκόντων ὄμμαθ’ ἥδιστον βλέπειν. 1000 ἦ γὰρ τάδ’ ὀκνῶν κεῖθεν ἦσθ’ ἀπόπτολις;	
1.1001	1001 πατρός τε χρῄζων μὴ φονεὺς εἶναι, γέρον. 1002 τί δῆτ’ ἐγὼ οὐχὶ τοῦδε τοῦ φόβου σ’, ἄναξ, 1003 ἐπείπερ εὔνους ἦλθον, ἐξελυσάμην; 1004 καὶ μὴν χάριν γ’ ἂν ἀξίαν λάβοις ἐμοῦ. 1005 καὶ μὴν μάλιστα τοῦτ’ ἀφικόμην, ὅπως 1006 σοῦ πρὸς δόμους ἐλθόντος εὖ πράξαιμί τι. 1007 ἀλλ’ οὔποτ’ εἶμι τοῖς φυτεύσασίν γ’ ὅμοῦ. 1008 ὦ παῖ, καλῶς εἶ δῆλος οὐκ εἰδὼς τί δρᾷς.	1011 Fearing indeed lest Apollo’s prophecy come true in me. 1012 Lest you acquire some pollution from your parents? 1013 This very thing, old man, this constantly frightens me. 1014 Do you know, then, that your fears are wholly in vain? 1015 How so, if I was born of those parents? 1016 Because you had no blood in common with Polybus. 1017 What are you saying? Was Polybus not my father? 1018 Just as much, and no more, than he who speaks to you. 1019 And how can my father be equal to him who is as though nothing to me? 1020 But he did not father you, any more than I did. 1021

	1009 πῶς, ὦ γεραιέ; πρὸς θεῶν δίδασκέ με. 1010 εἰ τῶνδε φεύγεις οὕνεκ’ εἰς οἴκους μολεῖν. 1011 ταρβῶν γε μή μοι Φοῖβος ἐξέλθῃ σαφής. 1012 ἢ μὴ μίασμα τῶν φυτευσάντων λάβῃς; 1013 τοῦτ’ αὐτό, πρέσβυ, τοῦτό μ’ εἰσαεὶ φοβεῖ. 1014 ἆρ’ οἶσθα δῆτα πρὸς δίκης οὐδὲν τρέμων; 1015 πῶς δ’ οὐχί, παῖς γ’ εἰ τῶνδε γεννητῶν ἔφυν; 1016 ὀθούνεκ’ ἦν σοι Πόλυβος οὐδὲν ἐν γένει. 1017 πῶς εἶπας; οὐ γὰρ Πόλυβος ἐξέφυσέ με; 1018 οὐ μᾶλλον οὐδὲν τοῦδε τἀνδρός, ἀλλ’ ἴσον. 1019 καὶ πῶς ὁ φύσας ἐξ ἴσου τῷ μηδενί; 1020 ἀλλ’ οὔ σ’ ἐγείνατ’ οὔτ’ ἐκεῖνος οὔτ’ ἐγώ. 1021 ἀλλ’ ἀντὶ τοῦ δὴ παῖδά μ’ ὠνομάζετο; 1022 δῶρόν ποτ’, ἴσθι, τῶν ἐμῶν χειρῶν λαβών. 1023 κᾆθ’ ὧδ’ ἀπ’ ἄλλης χειρὸς ἔστερξεν μέγα; 1024 ἡ γὰρ πρὶν αὐτὸν ἐξέπεισ’ ἀπαιδία. 1025 σὺ δ’ ἐμπολήσας ἢ τυχὼν μ’ αὐτῷ δίδως; 1026 εὑρὼν ναπαίαις ἐν Κιθαιρῶνος πτυχαῖς. 1027 ὠδοιπόρεις δὲ πρὸς τί τούσδε τοὺς τόπους; 1028 ἐνταῦθ’ ὀρείοις ποιμνίοις ἐπεστάτουν. 1029 ποιμὴν γὰρ ἦσθα κἀπὶ θητείᾳ πλάνης; 1030 σοῦ τ’, ὦ τέκνον, σωτήρ γε τῷ τότ’ ἐν χρόνῳ.	How, then, did he call me his son? 1022 Long ago he received you as a gift from my hands. 1023 And yet he loved me so dearly, who came from another’s hand? 1024 His former childlessness won him over. 1025 And had you bought me or found me by chance, when you gave me to him? 1026 I found you in Cithaeron’s winding glens. 1027 And why were you roaming those regions? 1028 I was in charge of mountain flocks. 1029 What, you were a shepherd—a vagrant hireling? 1030 But your savior, my son, in that hour. 1031 And what was my pain when you took me in your arms? 1032 The ankles of your feet might bear witness. 1033 Ah me, why do you speak of that old trouble? 1034 I freed you when you had your ankles pinned together. 1035 It was a dread brand of shame that I took from my cradle. 1036 So much so that from that fortune you were called by that name which you still bear. 1037 Oh, in the name of the gods, was the deed my mother’s or father’s? Speak! 1038 I know not. He who gave you to me knows better of that than I. 1039 What, you got me from another? You did not find me yourself? 1040 No. Another shepherd gave you to me.
1.1031	1031 τί δ’ ἄλγος ἴσχοντ’ ἀγκάλαις με λαμβάνεις; 1032 ποδῶν ἂν ἄρθρα μαρτυρήσειεν τὰ σά· 1033 οἴμοι, τί τοῦτ’ ἀρχαῖον ἐννέπεις κακόν; 1034 λύω σ’ ἔχοντα διατόρους ποδοῖν ἀκμάς. 1035 δεινόν γ’ ὄνειδος σπαργάνων ἀνειλόμην. 1036 ὥστ’ ὠνομάσθης ἐκ τύχης ταύτης ὃς εἶ. 1037 ὦ πρὸς θεῶν, πρὸς μητρὸς ἢ πατρός; φράσον.	1041 Who was he? Can you tell clearly? 1042 I think he was said to be one of the household of Laius. 1043 The king who ruled this country long ago? 1044 The same. The man was a herdsman in his service. 1045 Is he still alive, that I might see him? 1046 You natives of this country should know best. 1047 Is there any of you here present that knows the herdsman of whom he speaks, having seen him either in the pastures or here in town? Answer! 1050 The hour has come for these things to be revealed finally. 1051 I

	1038 οὐκ οἶδ’· ὁ δοὺς δὲ ταῦτ’ ἐμοῦ λῷον φρονεῖ. 1039 ἦ γὰρ παρ’ ἄλλου μ’ ἔλαβες οὐδ’ αὐτὸς τυχών; 1040 οὔκ, ἀλλὰ ποιμὴν ἄλλος ἐκδίδωσί μοι. 1041 τίς οὗτος; ἦ κάτοισθα δηλῶσαι λόγῳ; 1042 τῶν Λαΐου δήπου τις ὠνομάζετο. 1043 ἦ τοῦ τυράννου τῆσδε γῆς πάλαι ποτέ; 1044 μάλιστα· τούτου τἀνδρὸς οὗτος ἦν βοτήρ. 1045 ἦ κἄστ’ ἔτι ζῶν οὗτος, ὥστ’ ἰδεῖν ἐμέ; 1046 ὑμεῖς γ’ ἄριστ’ εἰδεῖτ’ ἂν οὐπιχώριοι. 1047 ἔστιν τις ὑμῶν τῶν παρεστώτων πέλας, 1048 ὅστις κάτοιδε τὸν βοτῆρ’ ὃν ἐννέπει, 1049 εἴτ’ οὖν ἐπ’ ἀγρῶν εἴτε κἀνθάδ’ εἰσιδών; 1050 σημήναθ’, ὡς ὁ καιρὸς ηὑρῆσθαι τάδε. 1051 οἶμαι μὲν οὐδέν’ ἄλλον ἢ τὸν ἐξ ἀγρῶν, 1052 ὃν κἀμάτευες πρόσθεν εἰσιδεῖν· ἀτὰρ 1053 ἥδ’ ἂν τάδ’ οὐχ ἥκιστ’ ἂν Ἰοκάστη λέγοι. 1054 γύναι, νοεῖς ἐκεῖνον, ὅντιν’ ἀρτίως 1055 μολεῖν ἐφιέμεσθα; τόνδ’ οὗτος λέγει; 1056 τί δ’ ὅντιν’ εἶπε; μηδὲν ἐντραπῇς· τὰ δὲ 1057 ῥηθέντα βούλου μηδὲ μεμνῆσθαι μάτην. 1058 οὐκ ἂν γένοιτο τοῦθ’ ὅπως ἐγὼ λαβὼν 1059 σημεῖα τοιαῦτ’ οὐ φανῶ τοὐμὸν γένος. 1060 μὴ πρὸς θεῶν, εἴπερ τι τοῦ σαυτοῦ βίου	think he speaks of no other than the peasant you already wanted to see. But our lady Iocasta might best tell you that. 1054 Lady, do you know the one whom we summoned just now? 1055 Is it of him that this man speaks? 1056 Why ask of whom he spoke? Regard it not; waste not a thought on what he said; it would be vain. 1058 It must not happen that, with such clues in my grasp, I fail to bring my birth to light. 1060 For the gods’ sake, if you have any care for your own life, do not continue this search! My anguish is enough. 1062 Be of good courage. Even if I should be found the son of a servile mother—a slave by three descents—you will not be proven baseborn. 1064 Hear me, I implore you: do not do this. 1065 I will not hear of not discovering the whole truth. 1066 Yet I wish you well—I counsel you for the best. 1067 These best counsels, then, vex my patience. 1068 Oh ill-fated man, may you never know who you are! 1069 Go, some one, fetch me the herdsman. 1070 Leave this woman to glory in her princely stock. 1071 Alas, alas, miserable man—that word alone can I say to you—and no other word ever again. She rushes into the palace. 1073 Why has this woman gone, Oedipus, rushing off in wild grief? I fear 1075 a storm of sorrow will soon break forth from this silence. 1076 Break forth what will! Be my race ever so lowly, I crave to learn it. That woman perhaps —for she is proud with more than a woman’s pride—feels ashamed of my lowly origin. But I, who hold myself son of Fortune 1080 that gives good, will not be dishonored. She is the mother from whom I spring, and the months, my kinsmen, have marked me sometimes lowly, sometimes great. Such being my heritage, never more can I prove 1085 false to it, or keep from searching out the secret of my birth.
1.1061	1061 κήδει, ματεύσῃς τοῦθ’· ἅλις νοσοῦσ’ ἐγώ. 1062 θάρσει· σὺ μὲν γὰρ οὐδ’ ἐὰν τρίτης ἐγὼ 1063 μητρὸς φανῶ τρίδουλος, ἐκφανεῖ κακή. 1064 ὅμως πιθοῦ μοι, λίσσομαι· μὴ δρᾶ τάδε. 1065 οὐκ ἂν πιθοίμην μὴ οὐ τάδ’	

	ἐκμαθεῖν σαφῶς. 1066 καὶ μὴν φρονοῦσά γ’ εὖ τὰ λῷστά σοι λέγω. 1067 τὰ λῷστα τοίνυν ταῦτά μ’ ἀλγύνει πάλαι. 1068 ὦ δύσποτμ’, εἴθε μήποτε γνοίης ὃς εἶ. 1069 ἄξει τις ἐλθὼν δεῦρο τὸν βοτῆρά μοι; 1070 ταύτην δ’ ἐᾶτε πλουσίῳ χαίρειν γένει. 1071 ἰοὺ ἰού, δύστηνε· τοῦτο γάρ σ’ ἔχω 1072 μόνον προσειπεῖν, ἄλλο δ’ οὔποθ’ ὕστερον. 1073 τί ποτε βέβηκεν, Οἰδίπους, ὑπ’ ἀγρίας 1074 ᾄξασα λύπης ἡ γυνή; δέδοιχ’ ὅπως 1075 μὴ ’κ τῆς σιωπῆς τῆσδ’ ἀναρρήξει κακά. 1076 ὁποῖα χρῄζει ῥηγνύτω· τοὐμὸν δ’ ἐγώ, 1077 κεἰ σμικρόν ἐστι, σπέρμ’ ἰδεῖν βουλήσομαι. 1078 αὕτη δ’ ἴσως, φρονεῖ γὰρ ὡς γυνὴ μέγα, 1079 τὴν δυσγένειαν τὴν ἐμὴν αἰσχύνεται. 1080 ἐγὼ δ’ ἐμαυτὸν παῖδα τῆς Τύχης νέμων 1081 τῆς εὖ διδούσης οὐκ ἀτιμασθήσομαι. 1082 τῆς γὰρ πέφυκα μητρός· οἱ δὲ συγγενεῖς 1083 μῆνές με μικρὸν καὶ μέγαν διώρισαν. 1084 τοιόσδε δ’ ἐκφὺς οὐκ ἂν ἐξέλθοιμ’ ἔτι 1085 ποτ’ ἄλλος, ὥστε μὴ ’κμαθεῖν τοὐμὸν γένος.	
1.1	1086 εἴπερ ἐγὼ μάντις εἰμὶ καὶ κατὰ γνώμαν ἴδρις, 1087 οὐ τὸν Ὄλυμπον ἀπείρων, ὦ Κιθαιρών, 1090 οὐκ ἔσει τὰν αὔριον 1091 πανσέληνον, μὴ οὐ σέ γε καὶ πατριώταν Οἰδίπουν 1092 καὶ τροφὸν καὶ ματέρ’ αὔξειν, 1095 καὶ χορεύεσθαι πρὸς ἡμῶν, ὡς ἐπὶ ἦρα φέροντα τοῖς ἐμοῖς τυράννοις. 1096 ἰήϊε Φοῖβε, σοὶ δὲ ταῦτ’ ἀρέστ’ εἴη.	
1.1	1098 τίς σε, τέκνον, τίς σ’ ἔτικτε τᾶν μακραιώνων ἄρα 1100 Πανὸς ὀρεσσιβάτα πατρὸς πελασθεῖσ’;	

	1101 ἢ σέ γ’ εὐνάτειρά τις 1102 Λοξίου; τῷ γὰρ πλάκες ἀγρόνομοι πᾶσαι φίλαι· 1105 εἴθ’ ὁ Κυλλάνας ἀνάσσων, 1106 εἴθ’ ὁ Βακχεῖος θεὸς ναίων ἐπ’ ἄκρων ὀρέων σ’ εὕρημα δέξατ’ ἔκ του 1107 Νυμφᾶν Ἑλικωνίδων, αἷς πλεῖστα συμπαίζει.	
1.1110	1110 εἰ χρή τι κἀμὲ μὴ συναλλάξαντά πω, 1111 πρέσβεις, σταθμᾶσθαι, τὸν βοτῆρ’ ὀρᾶν δοκῶ, 1112 ὅνπερ πάλαι ζητοῦμεν· ἔν τε γὰρ μακρῷ 1113 γήρᾳ ξυνᾴδει τῷδε τἀνδρὶ σύμμετρος, 1114 ἄλλως τε τοὺς ἄγοντας ὥσπερ οἰκέτας 1115 ἔγνωκ’ ἐμαυτοῦ· τῇ δ’ ἐπιστήμῃ σύ μου 1116 προύχοις τάχ’ ἄν που, τὸν βοτῆρ’ ἰδὼν πάρος. 1117 ἔγνωκα γάρ, σάφ’ ἴσθι· Λαΐου γὰρ ἦν 1118 εἴπερ τις ἄλλος πιστὸς ὡς νομεὺς ἀνήρ. 1119 σὲ πρῶτ’ ἐρωτῶ, τὸν Κορίνθιον ξένον, ἦ τόνδε φράζεις; 1120 τοῦτον, ὅνπερ εἰσορᾷς. 1121 οὗτος σύ, πρέσβυ, δεῦρό μοι φώνει βλέπων 1122 ὅσ’ ἄν σ’ ἐρωτῶ. Λαΐου ποτ’ ἦσθα σύ; 1123 ἦ δοῦλος οὐκ ὠνητός, ἀλλ’ οἴκοι τραφείς. 1124 ἔργον μεριμνῶν ποῖον ἢ βίον τινά; 1125 ποίμναις τὰ πλεῖστα τοῦ βίου συνειπόμην. 1126 χώροις μάλιστα πρὸς τίσι ξύναυλος ὤν; 1127 ἦν μὲν Κιθαιρών, ἦν δὲ πρόσχωρος τόπος. 1128 τὸν ἄνδρα τόνδ’ οὖν οἶσθα τῇδέ που μαθών; 1129 τί χρῆμα δρῶντα; ποῖον ἄνδρα καὶ λέγεις; 1130 τόνδ’ ὃς πάρεστιν· ἢ ξυναλλάξας τί πω; 1131 οὐχ ὥστε γ’ εἰπεῖν ἐν τάχει μνήμης ἄπο. 1132 κοὐδέν γε θαῦμα, δέσποτ’· ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ σαφῶς 1133 ἀγνῶτ’ ἀναμνήσω νιν. εὖ γὰρ οἶδ’ ὅτι 1134 κάτοιδεν, ἥμος τῷ Κιθαιρῶνος τόπῳ, 1135 ὁ μὲν διπλοῖσι ποιμνίοις, ἐγὼ δ’	1110 Elders, if it is right for me, who have never met the man, to guess, I think I see the herdsman we have been looking for for a long time. In his venerable old age he tallies with this stranger’s years, and moreover I recognize those who bring him, I think, as servants of mine. 1115 But perhaps you have an advantage in knowledge over me, if you have seen the herdsman before. 1117 Yes, I know him, be sure. He was in the service of Laius—trusty as any shepherd. 1119 I ask you first, Corinthian stranger, if this is the man you mean. 1120 He is, the one you are looking at. 1121 You, old man—look this way and answer all that I ask—were you once in the service of Laius? 1123 I was—not a bought slave, but reared in his house. 1124 Employed in what labor, or what way of life? 1125 For the better part of my life I tended the flocks. 1126 And what regions did you most frequently haunt? 1127 Sometimes Cithaeron, sometimes the neighboring ground. 1128 Are you aware of ever having seen this man in these parts? 1129 Doing what? What man do you mean? 1130 This man here. Have you ever met him before? 1131 Not so that I could speak at once from memory. 1132 And no wonder, master. But I will bring clear recollection to his ignorance. I am sure he knows well of the time we dwelled in the region of Cithaeron 1135 for six month periods, from spring to Arcturus, he with two flocks, and I, his comrade, with one. And then for the winter I used to drive my flock to my own fold, and he took his to the fold of Laius. 1140 Did any of this happen as I tell it, or did it not? 1141 You speak the truth, though it was long ago. 1142 Come, tell me now: do you remember having given me a boy in those days, to be reared as my own foster-son? 1144 What now? Why do you ask the question? 1145 This man, my friend, is he who then was young. 1146 Damn you! Be silent once

	ἐνί, 1136 ἐπλησίαζον τῷδε τἀνδρὶ τρεῖς ὅλους 1137 ἐξ ἧρος εἰς ἀρκτοῦρον ἐκμήνους χρόνους· 1138 χειμῶνα δ’ ἤδη τἀμά τ’ εἰς ἔπαυλ’ ἐγὼ 1139 ἤλαυνον οὗτός τ’ εἰς τὰ Λαΐου σταθμά.	and for all! 1147 Do not rebuke him, old man. Your words need rebuking more than his. 1148 And in what way, most noble master, do I offend? 1150 In not telling of the boy about whom he asks. 1151 He speaks without knowledge, but is busy to no purpose. 1152 You will not speak with good grace, but will in pain. 1153 No, in the name of the gods, do not mistreat an old man. 1154 Someone, quick—tie his hands him this instant!
1.1140	1140 λέγω τι τούτων ἢ οὐ λέγω πεπραγμένον; 1141 λέγεις ἀληθῆ, καίπερ ἐκ μακροῦ χρόνου. 1142 φέρ’ εἰπὲ νῦν, τότ’ οἶσθα παῖδά μοί τινα 1143 δούς, ὡς ἐμαυτῷ θρέμμα θρεψαίμην ἐγώ; 1144 τί δ’ ἔστι; πρὸς τί τοῦτο τοὔπος ἱστορεῖς; 1145 ὅδ’ ἐστίν, ὦ τᾶν, κεῖνος ὃς τότ’ ἦν νέος. 1146 οὐκ εἰς ὅλεθρον; οὐ σιωπήσας ἔσει; 1147 ἆ, μὴ κόλαζε, πρέσβυ, τόνδ’, ἐπεὶ τὰ σὰ 1148 δεῖται κολαστοῦ μᾶλλον ἢ τὰ τοῦδ’ ἔπη. 1149 τί δ’, ὦ φέριστε δεσποτῶν, ἁμαρτάνω; 1150 οὐκ ἐννέπων τὸν παῖδ’ ὃν οὗτος ἱστορεῖ. 1151 λέγει γὰρ εἰδὼς οὐδέν, ἀλλ’ ἄλλως πονεῖ. 1152 σὺ πρὸς χάριν μὲν οὐκ ἐρεῖς, κλαίων δ’ ἐρεῖς. 1153 μὴ δῆτα, πρὸς θεῶν, τὸν γέροντά μ’ αἰκίσῃ. 1154 οὐχ ὡς τάχος τις τοῦδ’ ἀποστρέψει χέρας; 1155 δύστηνος, ἀντὶ τοῦ; τί προσχρῄζων μαθεῖν; 1156 τὸν παῖδ’ ἔδωκας τῷδ’ ὃν οὗτος ἱστορεῖ; 1157 ἔδωκ’· ὀλέσθαι δ’ ὤφελον τῇδ’ ἡμέρᾳ. 1158 ἀλλ’ εἰς τόδ’ ἥξεις μὴ λέγων γε τοὔνδικον. 1159 πολλῷ γε μᾶλλον, ἢν φράσω, διόλλυμαι. 1160 ἀνὴρ ὅδ’, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐς τριβὰς ἐλᾷ. 1161 οὐ δῆτ’ ἔγωγ’, ἀλλ’ εἶπον, ὡς δοίην, πάλαι. 1162 πόθεν λαβών; οἰκεῖον ἢ ’ξ ἄλλου τινός;	1155 Alas, why? What do you want to learn? 1156 Did you give this man the child about whom he asks? 1157 I did. Would that I had perished that day! 1158 Well, you will come to that, unless you tell the honest truth. 1159 But if I speak I will be destroyed all the more. 1160 This man is bent, I think, on more delays. 1161 No, no! I said before that I gave it to him. 1162 Where did you get it from? From your own house, or from another? 1163 It was not my own: I received it from another. 1164 From whom of the citizens here? From what home? 1165 For the love of the gods, master, ask no more! 1166 You are dead if I have to question you again. 1167 It was a child, then, of the house of Laius. 1168 A slave? Or one of his own clan? 1169 Alas! I am on the brink of speaking the dreaded words. 1170 And I of hearing: I must hear nevertheless. 1171 You must know then, that it was said to be his own child. But your lady within could say best how these matters lie. 1173 How? Did she give it to you? 1173a Yes, my lord. 1174 For what purpose? 1174a That I should do away with it. 1175 Her own child, the wretched woman? 1175a Yes, from fear of the evil prophecies. 1176 What were they? 1176a The tale ran that he would slay his father. 1177 Why, then, did you give him to this old man? 1178 Out of pity, master, thinking that he would carry him to another land, from where he himself came. But he saved him for the direst woe. 1180 For if you are what this man says, be certain that you were born ill-fated. 1182 Oh, oh! All brought to pass, all true. Light, may I now look on you for the last time—I who have been found to be accursed in birth, 1185 accursed in wedlock, accursed in the shedding of blood. He rushes into the

	1163 ἐμὸν μὲν οὐκ ἔγωγ’, ἐδεξάμην δέ του. 1164 τίνος πολιτῶν τῶνδε κἀκ ποίας στέγης; 1165 μὴ πρὸς θεῶν, μή, δέσποθ’, ἱστόρει πλέον. 1166 ὅλωλας, εἴ σε ταῦτ’ ἐρήσομαι πάλιν. 1167 τῶν Λαΐου τοίνυν τις ἦν γεννημάτων. 1168 ἢ δοῦλος ἢ κείνου τις ἐγγενὴς γεγώς; 1169 οἴμοι, πρὸς αὐτῷ γ’ εἰμὶ τῷ δεινῷ λέγειν.	palace.
1.1170	1170 κἄγωγ’ ἀκούειν· ἀλλ’ ὅμως ἀκουστέον. 1171 κείνου γέ τοι δὴ παῖς ἐκλῄζεθ’· ἡ δ’ ἔσω 1172 κάλλιστ’ ἂν εἴποι σὴ γυνὴ τάδ’ ὡς ἔχει. 1173 ἦ γὰρ δίδωσιν ἥδε σοι; 1173a μάλιστ’, ἄναξ. 1174 ὡς πρὸς τί χρείας; 1174a ὡς ἀναλώσαιμί νιν. 1175 τεκοῦσα τλήμων; 1175a θεσφάτων γ’ ὅκνῳ κακῶν. 1176 ποίων; 1176a κτενεῖν νιν τοὺς τεκόντας ἦν λόγος. 1177 πῶς δῆτ’ ἀφῆκας τῷ γέροντι τῷδε σύ; 1178 κατοικτίσας, ὦ δέσποθ’, ὡς ἄλλην χθόνα 1179 δοκῶν ἀποίσειν, αὐτὸς ἔνθεν ἦν· ὁ δὲ 1180 κάκ’ εἰς μέγιστ’ ἔσωσεν. εἰ γὰρ οὗτος εἶ 1181 ὅν φησιν οὗτος, ἴσθι δύσποτμος γεγώς. 1182 ἰοὺ ἰού· τὰ πάντ’ ἂν ἐξήκοι σαφῆ. 1183 ὦ φῶς, τελευταῖόν σε προσβλέψαιμι νῦν, 1184 ὅστις πέφασμαι φύς τ’ ἀφ’ ὧν οὐ χρῆν, ξὺν οἷς τ’ 1185 οὐ χρῆν ὁμιλῶν, οὕς τέ μ’ οὐκ ἔδει κτανών.	
1.1	1186 ἰὼ γενεαὶ βροτῶν, 1187 ὡς ὑμᾶς ἴσα καὶ τὸ μηδὲν ζώσας ἐναριθμῶ. 1188 τίς γάρ, τίς ἀνὴρ πλέον 1190 τᾶς εὐδαιμονίας φέρει 1191 ἢ τοσοῦτον ὅσον δοκεῖν 1192 καὶ δόξαντ’ ἀποκλῖναι; 1193 τὸν σόν τοι παράδειγμ’ ἔχων, 1194 τὸν σὸν δαίμονα, τὸν σόν, ὦ τλᾶμον Οἰδιπόδα, βροτῶν 1195 οὐδὲν μακαρίζω·	

1.1	1196 ὅστις καθ’ ὑπερβολὰν 1197 τοξεύσας ἐκράτησε τοῦ πάντ’ εὐδαίμονος ὅλβου, 1198 ὦ Ζεῦ, κατὰ μὲν φθίσας 1199 τὰν γαμψώνυχα παρθένον 1200 χρησμῳδόν, θανάτων δ’ ἐμᾷ 1201 χώρᾳ πύργος ἀνέστα· 1201a ἐξ οὗ καὶ βασιλεὺς καλεῖ 1202 ἐμὸς καὶ τὰ μέγιστ’ ἐτιμάθης, ταῖς μεγάλαισιν ἐν 1203 Θήβαισιν ἀνάσσων.	
1.2	1204 τανῦν δ’ ἀκούειν τίς ἀθλιώτερος; 1205 τίς ἄταις ἀγρίαις, τίς ἐν πόνοις 1206 ξύνοικος ἀλλαγᾷ βίου; 1207 ἰὼ κλεινὸν Οἰδίπου κάρα, 1208 ἦ στέγας λιμὴν 1208a αὐτὸς ἤρκεσεν 1209 παιδὶ καὶ πατρὶ θαλαμηπόλῳ πεσεῖν; 1210 πῶς ποτε πῶς ποθ’ αἱ πατρῷαί σ’ ἄλοκες φέρειν, τάλας, 1211 σῖγ’ ἐδυνάθησαν ἐς τοσόνδε;	
1.2	1212 ἐφηῦρέ σ’ ἄκονθ’ ὁ πάνθ’ ὁρῶν χρόνος, 1213 δικάζει τ’ ἄγαμον γάμον πάλαι 1215 τεκνοῦντα καὶ τεκνούμενον. 1216 ἰώ, Λαΐειον ὦ τέκνον, 1217 εἴθε σ’ εἴθε σε 1217a μήποτ’ εἰδόμαν. 1218 δύρομαι γὰρ ὥσπερ ἰάλεμον χέων 1219 ἐκ στομάτων. τὸ δ’ ὀρθὸν εἰπεῖν, ἀνέπνευσά τ’ ἐκ 1220 σέθεν 1221 καὶ κατεκοίμασα τοὐμὸν ὄμμα.	
1.1	1297 ὦ δεινὸν ἰδεῖν πάθος ἀνθρώποις, 1298 ὦ δεινότατον πάντων ὅσ’ ἐγὼ 1299 προσέκυρσ’ ἤδη. τίς σ’, ὦ τλῆμον, 1300 προσέβη μανία; τίς ὁ πηδήσας 1301 μείζονα δαίμων τῶν μακίστων 1302 πρὸς σῇ δυσδαίμονι μοίρᾳ; 1303 φεῦ φεῦ, δύσταν’· 1304 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ἐσιδεῖν δύναμαί σε, θέλων 1305 πόλλ’ ἀνερέσθαι, πολλὰ πυθέσθαι, 1306 πολλὰ δ’ ἀθρῆσαι· 1307 τοίαν φρίκην παρέχεις μοι. 1308 αἰαῖ αἰαῖ, δύστανος ἐγώ, 1309 ποῖ γᾶς φέρομαι τλάμων; πᾷ μοι 1310 φθογγὰ διαπωτᾶται φοράδην; 1311 ἰὼ δαῖμον, ἴν’ ἐξήλλου. 1312 ἐς δεινὸν οὐδ’ ἀκουστὸν οὐδ’ ἐπόψιμον.	
1.1	1313 ἰὼ σκότου 1314 νέφος ἐμὸν ἀπότροπον, ἐπιπλόμενον ἄφατον,	

	1315 ἀδάματόν τε καὶ δυσούριστον ὄν. 1316 οἴμοι, 1317 οἴμοι μάλ’ αὖθις· οἷον εἰσέδυ μ’ ἅμα 1318 κέντρων τε τῶνδ’ οἴστρημα καὶ μνήμη κακῶν. 1319 καὶ θαῦμά γ’ οὐδὲν ἐν τοσοῖσδε πήμασιν 1320 διπλᾶ σε πενθεῖν καὶ διπλᾶ φορεῖν κακά.	
1.1	1321 ἰὼ φίλος, 1322 σὺ μὲν ἐμὸς ἐπίπολος ἔτι μόνιμος· ἔτι γὰρ 1323 ὑπομένεις με τὸν τυφλὸν κηδεύων. 1324 φεῦ φεῦ. 1325 οὐ γάρ με λήθεις, ἀλλὰ γιγνώσκω σαφῶς, 1326 καίπερ σκοτεινός, τήν γε σὴν αὐδὴν ὅμως. 1327 ὦ δεινὰ δράσας, πῶς ἔτλης τοιαῦτα σὰς 1328 ὄψεις μαρᾶναι; τίς σ’ ἐπῆρε δαιμόνων;	
1.2	1329 Ἀπόλλων τάδ’ ἦν, Ἀπόλλων, φίλοι, 1330 ὁ κακὰ κακὰ τελῶν ἐμὰ τάδ’ ἐμὰ πάθεα. 1331 ἔπαισε δ’ αὐτόχειρ νιν οὔτις, ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ τλάμων. 1332 τί γὰρ ἔδει μ’ ὁρᾶν, 1335 ὅτῳ γ’ ὁρῶντι μηδὲν ἦν ἰδεῖν γλυκύ; 1336 ἦν τᾷδ’ ὅπωσπερ καὶ σύ φῄς. 1337 τί δῆτ’ ἐμοὶ βλεπτὸν ἢ 1338 στερκτὸν ἢ προσήγορον 1339 ἔτ’ ἔστ’ ἀκούειν ἡδονᾷ φίλοι; 1340 ἀπάγετ’ ἐκτόπιον ὅ τι τάχιστά με, 1341 ἀπάγετ’, ὦ φίλοι, τὸν μέγ’ ὀλέθριον 1342 τὸν καταρατότατον, ἔτι δὲ καὶ θεοῖς 1345 ἐχθρότατον βροτῶν. 1346 δείλαιε τοῦ νοῦ τῆς τε συμφορᾶς ἴσον, 1347 ὡς σ’ ἠθέλησα μηδέ γ’ ἂν γνῶναί ποτε.	
1.2	1349 ὄλοιθ’ ὅστις ἦν, ὃς ἀγρίας πέδας 1350 μονάδ’ ἐπιποδίας ἔλυσ’ μ’ ἀπό τε φόνου 1351 ἔρυτο κἀνέσωσεν, οὐδὲν εἰς χάριν πράσσων. 1352 τότε γὰρ ἂν θανὼν 1355 οὐκ ἦ φίλοισιν οὐδ’ ἐμοὶ τοσόνδ’ ἄχος. 1356 θέλοντι κἀμοὶ τοῦτ’ ἂν ἦν.	

	1357 οὔκουν πατρός γ’ ἂν φονεὺς 1358 ἦλθον οὐδὲ νυμφίος 1359 βροτοῖς ἐκλήθην ὧν ἔφυν ἄπο. 1360 νῦν δ’ ἄθεος μέν εἰμ’, ἀνοσίων δὲ παῖς, 1361 ὁμολεχὴς δ’ ἀφ’ ὧν αὐτὸς ἔφυν τάλας. 1365 εἰ δέ τι πρεσβύτερον ἔτι κακοῦ κακόν, 1366 τοῦτ’ ἔλαχ’ Οἰδίπους.	
1.trochaic	1516 πειστέον, κεἰ μηδὲν ἡδύ. 1516a πάντα γὰρ καιρῷ καλά. 1517 οἶσθ’ ἐφ’ οἷς οὖν εἶμι; 1517a λέξεις, καὶ τότ’ εἴσομαι κλύων. 1518 γῆς μ’ ὅπως πέμψεις ἄποικον. 1518a τοῦ θεοῦ μ’ αἰτεῖς δόσιν. 1519 ἀλλὰ θεοῖς γ’ ἔχθιστος ἥκω. 1519a τοιγαροῦν τεύξει τάχα. 1520 φῂς τάδ’ οὖν; 1520a ἃ μὴ φρονῶ γὰρ οὐ φιλῶ λέγειν μάτην. 1521 ἄπαγέ νύν μ’ ἐντεῦθεν ἤδη. 1521a στεῖχέ νυν, τέκνων δ’ ἀφοῦ. 1522 μηδαμῶς ταύτας γ’ ἕλῃ μου. 1522a πάντα μὴ βούλου κρατεῖν· 1523 καὶ γὰρ ἀκράτησας οὗ σοι τῷ βίῳ ξυνέσπετο. 1524 ὦ πάτρας Θήβης ἔνοικοι, λεύσσετ’, Οἰδίπους ὅδε, 1525 ὃς τὰ κλείν’ αἰνίγματ’ ᾔδει καὶ κράτιστος ἦν ἀνήρ, 1526 οὗ τίς οὐ ζήλῳ πολιτῶν ἦν τύχαις ἐπιβλέπων, 1527 εἰς ὅσον κλύδωνα δεινῆς συμφορᾶς ἐλήλυθεν. 1528 ὥστε θνητὸν ὄντα κείνην τὴν τελευταίαν ἰδεῖν 1529 ἡμέραν ἐπισκοποῦντα μηδέν’ ὀλβίζειν, πρὶν ἂν 1530 τέρμα τοῦ βίου περάσῃ μηδὲν ἀλγεινὸν παθών.	1460 they are men, so that they will never lack the means to live wherever they should be. My two girls, poor hapless ones—who never knew my table spread separately, or lacked their father’s presence, but always had a share of all that 1465 reached my hands—I implore you to take care of them. And, if you can, allow me to touch them with my hands, and to indulge my grief. Grant it, prince, grant it, noble heart. Ah, if I could but once touch them with my hands, I would think that I had them 1470 just as when I had sight. 1471 What is this? Oh, gods, can it be my loved ones that I hear sobbing, can Creon have taken pity on me and sent my children, my darlings? 1475 Am I right? 1476 You are. I have brought this about, for I knew the joy which you have long had from them—the joy you now have. 1478 Bless you, and for this errand may the god prove a kinder guardian to you than he has to me. 1480 My children, where are you? Come, here, here to the hands of the one whose mother was your own, the hands that have made your father’s once bright eyes to be such orbs as these—his, who seeing nothing, knowing nothing, 1485 became your father by her from whom he was born! For you also do I weep, though I cannot see you, when I think of the bitter life that men will make you live in days to come. To what company of the citizens will you go, to what festival, 1490 from which you will not return home in tears, not sharing in the holiday? But when you reach a ripe age for marriage, who shall he be, who shall be the man, my daughters, to risk taking upon himself the reproaches 1495 that will certainly be baneful to my offspring and yours? What misery is lacking? Your father killed his own father, and bore you from the source of his own being! 1500 Such are the

		taunts that will be cast at you. And who then will wed you? The man does not live, no, it cannot be, my children, but you will wither in barren maidenhood. Son of Menoeceus, hear me: since you are the only father left to them—we, their parents, are both gone— 1505 do not allow them to wander poor and unwed, for they are your own kin, nor abase them to the level of my woes. Pity them, seeing them deprived of everything but you at such an age. 1510 Promise, noble man, and touch them with your hand. To you, children, I would have given much counsel, if your minds were mature. But now pray that you may live where occasion allows, and that the life which is your lot may be happier than your father's. 1515 Your grief has had a sufficient scope: move on into the house. 1516 I must obey, though I do it in no way gladly. 1516a Yes, for it is in season that all things are good. 1517 Do you know on what terms I will go? 1517a You will tell me, and then I will know when I have heard them. 1518 See that you send me to dwell outside this land. 1518a You ask for what the god must give. 1519 But to the gods I have become most hateful. 1519a Then you will quickly get your wish. 1520 So you consent? 1520a It is not my way to say idly what I do not mean. 1521 Then it is time to lead me away. 1521a Come, then, but let your children go. 1522 No, do not take them from me! 1523 Do not wish to be master in all things: the mastery which you did attain has not followed you through life. 1524 Residents of our native Thebes, behold, this is Oedipus, 1525 who knew the renowned riddle, and was a most mighty man. What citizen did not gaze on his fortune with envy? See into what a stormy sea of troubles he has come! Therefore, while our eyes wait to see the final destined day, we must call no mortal happy until 1530 he has crossed life's border free from pain.